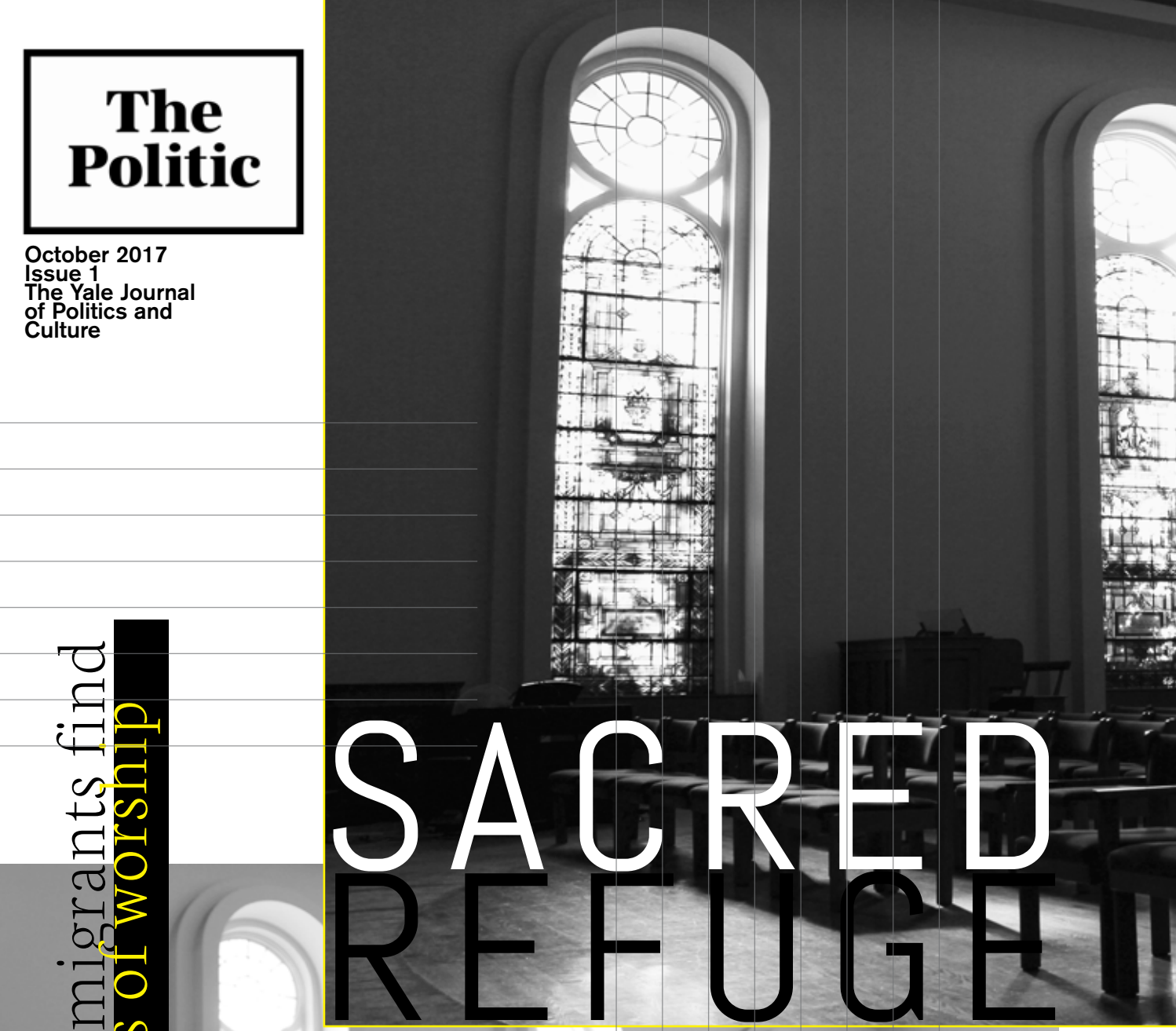
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SACRED REFUGE

undocumented immigrants find sanctuary in places of worship



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The Politic

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[Change of Course].

BY **MOLLY SHAPIRO**

YALE PROFESSORS REVISE SYLLABI AFTER TRUMP

"IT'S DEFINITELY ADDED URGENCY to my teaching, there's no question about that," Michael Fotos, political science professor at Yale, told *The Politic*.

The 2016 presidential election rocked Yale's student body. Students gathered in Dwight Hall Chapel to reflect and commiserate, members of the community massed on Cross Campus to protest, and bulletin boards featured fliers proclaiming "love trumps hate" and "you are loved." Some professors decided to revise their syllabi due to the election results. Others did not, but have nonetheless seen their classrooms affected by Donald Trump's victory.

Speaking to *The Politic*, Ayesha Ramachandran, assistant professor of Comparative Literature, said professors have two basic options: They can either adjust lesson plans with the political climate or continue to teach canonical material as a way of "standing up to the present moment."

Ramachandran, a woman of color, reflected on the ways in which her thinking has changed over time. Recalling her time as a college student, Ramachandran said: "I did not spend a lot of time thinking about my own minority status as a student." Now, however, on topics of selfhood, race, and gender, she has "come to see how important it is to...speak out, especially when you're in a position of power."

Graeme Wood, a journalist and lecturer in political science at Yale, emphasized a different perspective: classrooms as safe havens from the drama of current events.

"I do think one of the advantages of being in the university is that you have the chance to step back from the barrage of information...and think more abstractly about something with a level of remove from the daily or hourly news," Wood told *The Politic*.

Distance from the 24-hour news cycle can prove beneficial. "It's good for us to be able to remember that the present moment is not the only one, and a good way to do that is to leave the discussion of day-to-day affairs to day-to-day and concentrate on the things that we wouldn't get elsewhere," Wood said.

Hélène Landemore, associate professor of political science, also emphasized the importance of looking beyond Trump's latest tweet: "Inequalities, injustice, all of these things are very much there whether Trump is at the helm or not."

She added, "I'm all for reacting to events, and trying to process them, like when they are really clearly disrupting the classroom dynamic anyway, but I wouldn't do that for everything. If you spend your time reacting, when do you think?"

Some professors are wary of alienating students on the right if current events feature prominently in discussions. Landemore said constant discussion of current politics can actually be counterproductive. "It's just going to alienate the few conservatives who are there to think aloud, and it's not good for the liberals either," she said. "Trump bashing is actually very cheap. What good does it do? I think we need to think beyond Trump."

Mariel Barocas '21 agreed that diversity of opinions is important.

In light of the current

"Yale classrooms should be a place where political discourse is encouraged, and the teachers should provide a new perspective...to add to the exploration of ideas and ideologies," she said.

Isaiah Schrader '21 said that he wants to hear his professors' perspectives. "Academics research [and] then form beliefs for a living," he told *The Politic*. "The political insight of a Yale professor is a valuable opinion. No one has to agree with the opinions of their professor, but we are here to learn from them."

To make the classroom a welcoming environment for all perspectives, Ramachandran said she is honest about her own political viewpoints and encourages her students to be open as well.

"Rather than preserving a kind of illusion of objectivity, I think that both the nature of the class and our own commitments are such that [my co-professor and I] think it's important to speak about—and call out—what's subjective, to recognize it as such, and then to make room for other ideas," she said.

Ramachandran designed her course, "Selfhood, Race, Class, and Gender," before the election, but taught it for the first time afterwards.

"Teaching the course in its first iteration last spring, just in the wake of the election, was...an amazing experience for us simply because we realized how things that had seemed urgent but not politically immediate suddenly were politically immediate," she said.

Fotos, who teaches Democracy and Sustainability and American Political Institutions courses, had a similar experience. While he was teaching topics he had covered in the classroom before, Fotos said the lessons felt different this year.

"There's no question that it was an emotional experience to teach it last spring—for me and, I think, the students," he said of teaching a lesson on the Civil War after the election.

Unlike Ramachandran, Fotos chose to alter his curriculum in the wake of the election. He integrated more of Dr. Martin Luther King's writings on basic democratic processes, as well as more of Abraham Lincoln's writing.

"The United States has always been a project of moral improvement," he explained, "and I think that Trump's election makes it really important that people understand that even a moral people can fall short. I want my students to recognize what it means to fall short, but also to recognize what it means to see the vision and to be part of the vision."

Wood has also adapted his course, Media and Conflict, to address the consequences of the election. "The Trump election...made me revise some of the readings a bit to have a less naive view of what persuades people," he said.

"Many of us hope, wish, and sometimes even believe that what persuades people is fact and that whoever has the best facts wins," he continued. "I think the Trump election is one of the starker demonstrations that that view requires revision."

Other courses are, by their nature,

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>> Students had noticed that almost everything I discussed as a semi-rigid rule of political science and politics in January had been proven wrong <<

presidency...

> "Inequalities, injustice, all of these things are very much there whether Trump is at the helm or not."

obliged to change along with political developments. Walter Shapiro, a journalist and a lecturer in political science, said in an interview with *The Politic* that he has drastically rethought the syllabus of his course, "Presidential Campaigns and the Media."

"Students had noticed that almost everything I discussed as a semi-rigid rule of political science and politics in January had been proven wrong," he said. Shapiro is currently in the process of redesigning portions of his second semester course, something that he often does following an election, but seldom to this extent.

Stephen Skowronek, professor of political science, is also accustomed to revising the curriculum for his course, "The American Presidency," with each passing election. This year, however, he has found himself rethinking not only the course readings but also his views on the Office of the President.

"I think [Trump is] a fascinating case that has all sorts of implications not only for what I have written about the presidency but for what others have written about the presidency. And we'll see how it plays out. I think this is great for political science," Skowronek said.

Andrew Gamzon '20, a student in Skowronek's course on the presidency, said in an interview with *The Politic* that discussion of Trump in the classroom is acceptable "as long as the content is constructive and respectful."

Another student in Skowronek's course, Ali Vandebunt '21, said that she took the course because she hoped to learn more about the current president.

"I specifically chose to take this class this semester because of the Trump presidency," she told *The Politic*. "I thought it would be incredibly interesting to have the curriculum be affected daily by Trump's decisions within his first year in office and compare those decisions to ones prior presidents have made."

Whether or not they choose to adjust their course syllabi, professors agree that the election has changed the way students think about politics.

On the first day of "Introduction to Political Philosophy," Landemore asked her students if they think they live in a democracy. She estimated that less than half of the class raised their hands.

"If I had asked this question five years ago, I think ninety percent would have said yes, we live in a democracy, everything's great," Landemore predicted.

Perhaps in five more years, after Trump's first term is complete, Landemore will ask the question again and find the response has changed. In what way? Not even the nation's foremost political scientists can predict.

> If you spend your time reacting,
> when do you think?"

Homely Hounds

Defining Ugly at the World's Ugliest Dog Contest

BY **THOMAS C. MARTIN**



MARTHA IS A SNORER. When she dozes, it sounds like a Boeing 747 revving up on the tarmac. She also has a drooling problem. Her bipedal best friend, Shirley, warns others that when they meet Martha, their clothes might accidentally get slimed. Sometimes Martha gets a bit gassy, and she has a lot of wrinkles for a three-year-old.

But make no mistake. Martha, a 125-pound Neapolitan mastiff and the reigning champion of the World's Ugliest Dog Contest, is at the top of her game.

Martha's win on Friday, June 23 was a fluke: She almost didn't even enter the competition.

"It was kind of a last-minute thing," Shirley Zindler, Martha's former foster-parent, told *The Politic*.

Zindler fostered Martha after the mastiff received surgery for injuries to her eyes. Zindler looked at this slobbery, bovine creature, and then remembered the upcoming contest just a few days away. A light bulb went off and Zindler registered her for the competition. Martha, the new queen of ugly, was crowned just two days later.

Besides entering late, Martha was an unexpected victor for a more notable reason: Martha is not a Chinese crested.

The Chinese crested breed is to the World's Ugliest Dog Contest what Usain Bolt is to Olympic sprinting. The competition has been held annually since 1976; in the last sixteen years, Chinese cresteds have taken home the gold a staggering nine times.

While there are two types of cresteds—the hairless and the powderpuff—the hairless variety is the showstopper at the World's Ugliest Dog Contest. If a crossbreed between a Clydesdale horse and a Barbie doll were shrunk down to the size of a cat, the result would approximate the curious blend of grace, exoticism, and nearly cabalistic spectacle that defines the hairless crested.

The origin story of the Chinese crested is muddled: Even the American Kennel Club (AKC) isn't quite sure where they came from. Some think they evolved from African hairless dogs and were then bred to be small by Chinese sailors. They were popular on voyages because of their catlike predilection for hunting vermin but are now commonly kept as house pets or show dogs.

But the hairless cresteds at the World's Ugliest Dog Contest are not well-bred in any sense. The AKC breed standard defines the ideal crested as "fine-boned, elegant, and graceful." The ones that compete in the World's Ugliest Dog Contest are usually larger

If a crossbreed between a Clydesdale horse an approximate the curious blend of grace, exoti

If the dogs do have such thoughts, the question then becomes: do these dogs think they're ugly?

than the standard prescribes. Many of these cresteds have lost their teeth from old age, and their gaits tend to be awkward and gangly.

But should any of that actually matter?

Bev Nicholson, the owner of Mugly, the 2012 winner of the contest, doesn't think so.

Nicholson, who lives in Peterborough, England, told *The Politic* in an interview that the first time she ever saw Mugly was in a photograph that her friend sent her while she was visiting an animal shelter in Wales.

"They sent me this photo back of this scrawny little thing," Nicholson said, describing Mugly as "a bag of skin with big beady eyes."

The moment she saw that photo, her decision was made. "I need that dog."

She adopted him in 2004, when he was just eight weeks old. Nicholson has never viewed Mugly's victory as offensive.

"I've always seen it for what it is," she told me, "just funny."

But for Karen Cooper, the President of the American Chinese Crested Club (ACCC), the World's Ugliest Dog Contest is no laughing matter.

The ACCC enrolls all official breeders of Chinese cresteds in the country and ensures that they adhere to responsible breeding regulations. It should come as no surprise that members of this club, whose stated purpose is "to bring [the Chinese cresteds'] natural qualities to perfection," hold the World's Ugliest Dog Contest in low regard.

Cooper put it bluntly: "They hate it."

She doubts whether the cresteds who compete are truly purebred, calling them all "crossbreeds." While it's true that the competition accepts mixed-breed dogs, many of the contestants are not mutts—they are just that ugly.

Mugly is a bona fide purebred, but he, like most of the competitors, does not fit his breed standard at all. His head crest is scraggly like steel wool, and his expression, which should be "alert and intense" according to the crested breed standard, is wearily sympathetic, like a retired psychiatrist's. His bald hide is mottled and uneven, and his feet, which should be covered with fur, are bony and bare, not unlike chicken legs.

Mugly was the perfect addition to the family. Nicholson's friends came over to see Mugly frequently, and he was warm and outgoing with all of them.

Eventually the press discovered him. Nicholson was inundated with calls for news articles and daytime television appearances featuring Mugly, whom the media dubbed "Britain's Ugliest Dog" in 2005.

When Mugly was eight years old, Nicholson was approached by the



d a Barbie doll were shrunk down to the size of a cat, the result would cism, and nearly cabalistic spectacle that defines the hairless crested.

television network Channel 5, which offered her an all-expense-paid trip to the U.S. for the 2012 World's Ugliest Dog Contest, coupled with a film deal. She accepted the offer and registered Mugly for the competition soon after.

Nicholson and Mugly flew into San Francisco, but the World's Ugliest Dog Contest is actually held about 40 miles north, in Petaluma, CA. It just one event during the five-day-long Sonoma-Marin county fair.

To say that the dogs are given celebrity treatment is an understatement. Members of the press lobby to get the perfect shot of the victor. The dogs ascend a literal red carpet onto the stage before judging. A puppy psychic, apparently convinced that dogs have inner thoughts, attempts to read the contestants' minds. If the dogs do have such thoughts, the question then becomes: Do these dogs think they're ugly?

According to Yale University psychologist Dr. Laurie Santos, probably not.

Santos directs the Canine Cognition Center at Yale, which conducts research on the ways dogs think, learn, and interact with humans.

"Dogs share many basic aspects of social cognition with humans," Santos told *The Politic* in an email. But while dogs may use some of the same social cues that we humans use, her research suggests that the dogs who compete in the World's Ugliest Dog Contest do not consider themselves

"Dogs are probably not using the same cues we use as humans to judge their attractiveness," Santos said. To a dog, the windows to the soul are not the eyes, but the nostrils.

Santos explained that when a female dog is "in oestrus," or in heat, she emits a scent that signals her fertility to male dogs in order to attract them. Vision has little to do with canine attraction—dogs can't even recognize themselves in mirrors. Though they can discern their own scent from other dogs', that skill alone does not suggest a complex, human-like self-esteem, according to Santos.

But Nicholson remains unconvinced. "He's very human," she claimed of Mugly.

When Nicholson and Mugly arrived in San Francisco, it took them a day to orient themselves and meet up with their television crew. The following day, the pair went sightseeing in the city. Mugly wore a glitzy sequined tuxedo and a sparkling blue top hat—Nicholson calls it his "Union Jack outfit."

After a couple of hours walking around, people began to recognize the conspicuous pup on the street. Strangers would snatch Mugly off the ground and hand Nicholson their phones, asking for selfies with him.

Though at the time she thought the situation was "really bizarre," Nicholson now recalls the ordeal as "quite amusing."

The publicity gained by Mugly and the other winning hairless cresteds irritates Cooper and most members of the ACCC.

Cooper has been involved with the breed since it was first recognized by the AKC. Until 1991, Chinese cresteds were cast in the "miscellaneous" category, a puppy purgatory for lesser-known breeds who are not yet officially recognized. Just two years after the breed was acknowledged by the AKC, Cooper purchased her first Chinese crested. She began breeding them shortly after that.

Cooper's appreciation for the crested breed has only grown now that she serves as an AKC judge. Her style might even be called absolutist.

"You judge everything against the written standard," Cooper said, adding that personal preferences are discarded the minute one enters the ring. "We have all got prejudices. We like certain things, we might like certain colors, and you try your best to ignore those prejudices."

The judging of the World's Ugliest Dog Contest seems almost capricious in comparison.

The first stage of the contest is separated into two groups: purebreds and mixed-breeds. Mugly, a full-blooded crested, was in the former category.

Nicholson led Mugly up the red carpet to the center of the stage. She lifted Mugly onto a small table for three judges to examine him. Flashes from reporters' DSLRs cast the pair in a glaring light. The judges asked him questions as if he were going to answer them out loud, like "Are you going to enjoy the chef's chicken dinner tonight, Mugly?" Mugly swept his category handily, as did a Mexican hairless mix named Creature, who won the mutt category. Now it was time for the final round.

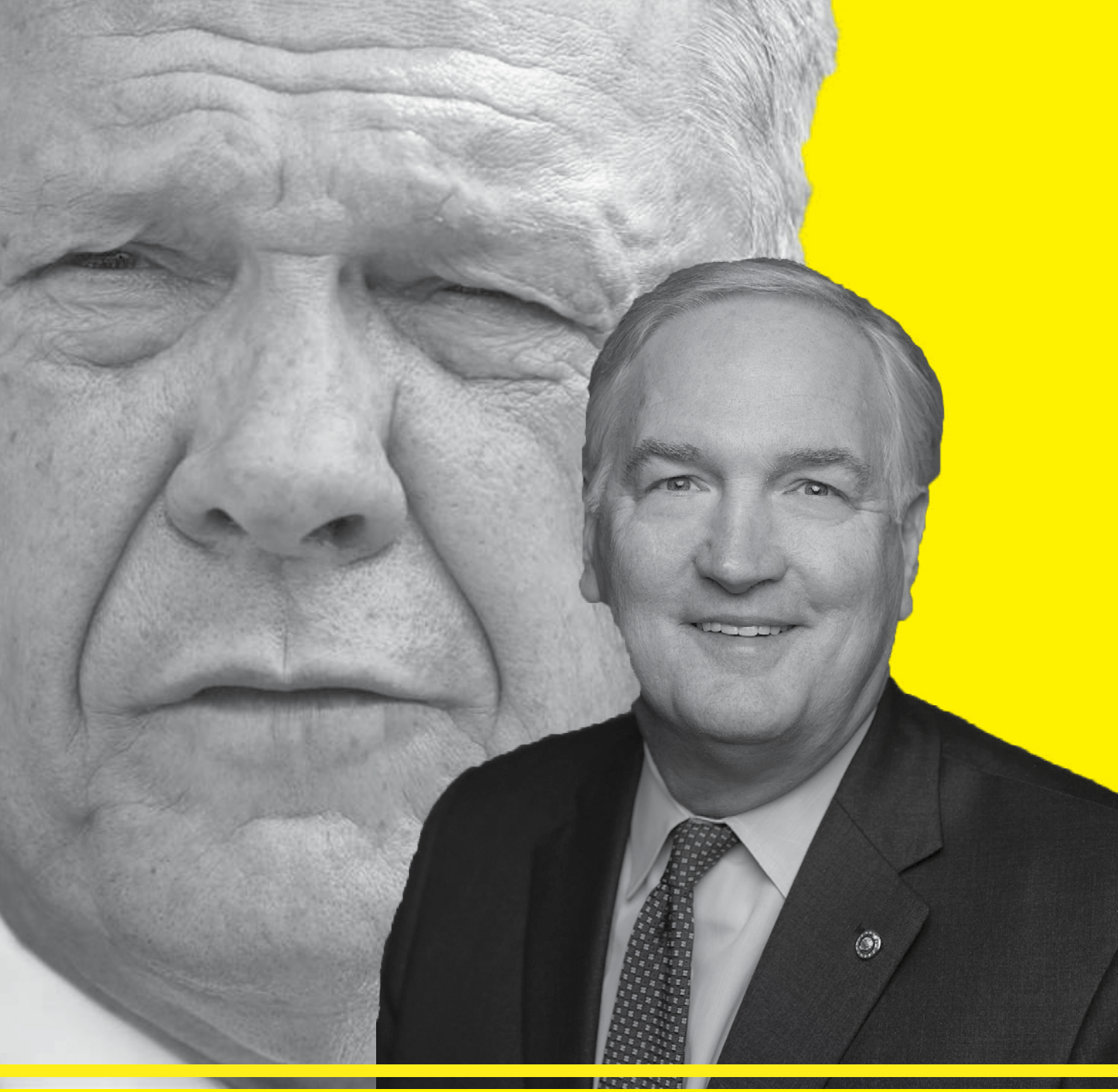
Creature and Mugly stood shoulder to shoulder on stage facing the crowd. Creature leaned over to sniff Mugly like a wrestler psyching out his opponent. But Mugly was unperturbed.

To a dog, the windows to the soul are not the eyes, but the nostrils.

The final winner is decided mostly by audience reaction. The emcee asked the crowd who they thought should win. Three thousand voices howled "MUGLY!" The emcee smiled and looked over at Nicholson.

"The Brit has won it," she announced.

Nicholson could hear nothing over the roar.



Strange-Moore in Strange Times

An Alabama Election Exposes Faultlines in the GOP

BY **TRENT KANNEGIETER**

GALLANT, ALABAMA. Population: 208. Technically too small to be a town, it is officially labeled a "census-designated place."

That said, on August 15, Gallant was a powerful emblem of our democracy. It was election day, with Alabama hosting the primary to eventually fill the Senate seat once owned by Attorney General Jefferson Beauregard Sessions III.

While voters waited to fill out their ballots, a 70 year-old man in a black t-shirt, jeans, and a cowboy hat emerged on horseback from the tangled shrubbery and trotted toward the polling station.

The man told reporters that he rides his horse, Sassy, every time he votes. Proud of his family's history of equestrian proficiency and civic participation, he presented himself as a simple man. His father worked construction in Etowah County. He served in Vietnam. And he based almost all of his decisions on the Bible's teachings. Sure, some of the man's views were a little out there—he thought Islam was a "false religion"—but nonetheless, he was participating in the democratic process.

But the man on the horse was not just a voter. He was a candidate. And now, after two rounds of a GOP primary, Roy Moore is likely to become the newest senator for the state of Alabama.

Wait, what?

BORN IN GADSDEN during the city's postwar industrial boom, Roy Moore studied at West Point and served in the Vietnam War. Afterwards, he spent a year as a professional kickboxer before travelling to the Australian outback for a reprieve as an actual, honest-to-god cowboy. When asked about his most prolific moments in these years, Moore interlaced his account with one motif: divine intervention.

During these wanderings, Moore prepared for his eventual career: Justice of the Peace in Alabama. He won his first commission in his old hometown of Etowah and eventually rose to national prominence due to an incident that cost him the bench.

In July 2001, Moore, then Chief Justice of Alabama, unveiled a two-and-a-half-ton marble monument of the Ten Commandments, complete with a copyright attributed to himself, in the center of the state courthouse. When asked to dismantle the piece, he refused, reminding constituents of his belief that "government is…pretending that it gives us our rights [when] those rights come from God."

But Moore's "return to the knowledge of God in our land" was short-lived, as federal courts insisted the statue fall. Instead of deferring to the supremacy of federal law, Moore insisted the Tenth Amendment vindicated his decision—the fact that the federal government can't establish a state church, he argued, did not mean that Alabama could not—and fell on his sword, losing his job along with the monument.

Nevertheless, Moore's career rose from the grave, and, in 2011, he retook the same office with a torrent of popular support behind him. Instead of shying away from his former antics, he doubled down, and stood by his conviction that religion supersedes the state once again after the Supreme Court's *Obergefell v. Hodges* decision. In the midst of the Kim Davis controversy, he demanded state bureaucrats not offer marriage licenses to homosexual couples. Again, he cited the Lord's law. And, again, the federal government removed him.

With one incident after another, the government has repeatedly censored Moore. Nevertheless, he might be just months away from representing his state in the U.S. Senate. And he is currently at the successful conclusion of his most audacious ruse yet: He has made one of Donald Trump's most enthusiastic backers seem too moderate to win.

Strange Things

TO UNDERSTAND Senator Luther Strange's platform, look no further than the commercials that Sessions' interim replacement ran before the August primary. Locked in a tight three-way race for two runoff spots, Strange went after Mo Brooks, the current representative for Alabama's Fifth Congressional District. Brooks's fierce Tea Party agenda and fiery rhetoric provided plenty of fodder for a smear campaign. Nonetheless, when Strange wanted to crystalize one issue in voters' minds, he played soundbite after soundbite of Brooks' condemnation of then-candidate Donald Trump following the emergence of the now-infamous *Access Hollywood* tape. That attack resonated with Alabama voters, 62 percent of whom opted for Trump last November, and Brooks came in third place in the Senate primary.

"If polls came out say
Communist, the first p
the statehouse would b
Moore, he believes in

Although at 6'9", Strange stands taller than any other senator in history, he spent the last few months trying to hide behind Trump's populist shadow. He doubled down on building the wall—a real one—and, according to his official campaign site, "banning refugees in terrorist countries from entering our borders." In fact, on Strange's issues page, "Supporting President Trump" was in itself the second most prominent policy.

In a way, this strategy made sense, as Strange did not have much of a policy background to call upon, and his national experience only extended half a year.

But his endorsement by Trump himself, affirmed by the President's September trip to Huntsville for a rally, made him a powerful opponent on the campaign trail.

In any other scenario, Strange would have been hand-picked, straight from central casting, to win the seat in a landslide. But Moore did not just match Strange—he left him in the dust. Why? In a state where voters traditionally select candidates with a combination of conservatism and evangelism, Moore split the two. He presented himself as the more evangelical candidate, and let Strange be more conservative, forcing voters to choose one over the other.

The former Chief Justice has unabashedly criticized Trump's morality, both in his not-Christian-enough policies and in his personal decorum. To Wayne Flint, professor emeritus of History at Auburn University, Moore's success is a result of his unflinching "my way or the highway" approach.

"Interestingly, [in his time as a justice, Moore] never asked Catholics and Jews to lead in prayer," Flint told *The Politic*. "He never reached out. Instead, he is making his own beliefs normative."

As he normalized his own convictions, the base followed, with evangelical adherents capitalizing on the opportunity to control the state's legislative voice.

When Strange tried to offer an equally compelling, populist GOP alternative, he was hampered by his own background. As a former lobbyist with a dubious path to power, his promises to "drain the swamp" fell flat.

"Regardless of your party, it's hard to say Luther rose to power under anything but shaky circumstances," Roy Johnson, a columnist with the Alabama Media Group, which owns most newspapers in the state, told *The Politic*. "Any Alabama voter will be aware that Strange was investigating former Governor [Robert] Bentley [for corruption charges which would later force the Governor to resign] and curiously dropped the investigation when he was promoted to the Senate seat by the same man."

Flint went even further, deploring "Big Luther" as "the ultimate establishment candidate," despite Strange's commitment to Trumpism. As Flint pointed out, a lobbyist for big corporations in Washington was a poor fit for a state that usually prefers home-grown talent. This perception of Strange as Washington insider was only exacerbated by Strange's campaign finances—Senate Republicans funneled money to the Senator, bankrolling most of the aforementioned anti-Brooks spots.

Nevertheless, much of this precariousness is par for the course in the state. As Johnson explained, "Unethical politics has a long and proud history in Alabama."

And the trend is accelerating. The governor, Robert Bentley, and the speaker of the house, Mike Hubbard, were both removed from office for misallocation of funds and embezzlement, respectively, within the last 14 months.

In order to understand Moore's appeal, it is important to look past corruption into the gut feelings that power both campaigns. By stoking the evangelical fervor which pervades the state's political and social culture, Moore mobilized polls and pews alike.

First, to many, Moore's appeals simply resonate. His insistence on the supremacy of God's law doesn't just attract a support base—it demands a zealous one. As Johnson said, "they don't call [central Alabama] the Bible Belt for nothing."

In a primary with a voter turnout below 18 percent, it should come as no surprise that high-

ing 51 percent of the state were
person to run a hammer and sickle over
e Luther. Say what you will about Roy
all of his crazy."

"People just don't know there's an election."

ly motivated evangelicals were among the few who showed up. Religious zeal might be polemical for policy, but it is great for mobilizing a base.

Alabama's evangelical ardor is not the only factor at play. As Flint pointed out, Alabamians have always sought "anti-establishment" officials. For candidates from Moore to Sessions to segregationist Governor George Wallace, standing up to the the federal government has long been enough to garner Alabama citizens' approval. Strange failed to master this rebellious sentiment—instead he attempted to substitute it with something voters saw as a tendency for political opportunism.

Flint remarked that Moore has stood by his principles more than Strange has. "If polls came out saying 51 percent of the state were Communist, the first person to run a hammer and sickle over the statehouse would be Luther. Say what you will about Roy Moore, he believes in all of his crazy," he said.

Even though Moore has criticized Trump, they share a common appeal. "At the end of the day, more voters are convinced Roy Moore is like Trump, while Luther speaks like Trump," said Flint.

Those emphasizing evangelism like Moore offer an especially dangerous threat to Trump, by potentially siphoning off his most powerful base: Deep South conservatives. Donald Trump ascended to the Oval Office on calls to drain the swamp and turn the establishment on its head. Now that he is the establishment, how does he inspire his base?

Now What?

AFTER A BLOODY primary, Moore faces a heavyweight Democrat in the general election.

Doug Jones won the Democratic primary in such striking fashion that no runoff was needed. With views in line with those of "mainstream" Democrats, Jones' renown has roots in his work prosecuting the perpetrators of the infamous 16th Street Baptist Church bombing in Birmingham during the Civil Rights Movement. Despite the fact that no Democrat has won a U.S. Senate election in Alabama since 1992, Jones' supporters have hope.

"As a result of [the Republican] situation, our candidate has a good chance of winning," said Mary Parker, who leads the Jones campaign in Baldwin County, Alabama, in an interview with *The Politic*.

Deep South Democrats are capitalizing on their rejuvenated base with high levels of political participation. One such Democrat is Parker, who described herself as "a lifelong Democrat [who] wasn't active in statewide elections because we haven't had as phenomenal a candidate in a long time as Doug Jones."

With the potent combination of 2016's aftermath and Jones's entrance into the election, "a whole lot of people jumped in immediately," she said.

"Doug Jones is not making the mistake that Democrats made in Georgia or Montana," said Flint, who also supports the candidate. "That is, he has not made his campaign against Trump. He's been very low key. He is not painting himself as an outsider, he is well known and almost universally liked, largely because his only real public venture into Alabama public life was [prosecuting the 16th Street Baptist case]. So, even extreme conservatives know him for one good thing he did, which they support."

As for what will happen in the election, the final result will likely come down to a factor less glamorous than the race itself: voter turnout.

Parker has spoken to several Democrats who were unaware of the irregularly-scheduled December contest. "People just don't know there's an election," she said.

Regardless of the result, the Alabama special Senate election illuminates a schism in the Republican power structure. If it turns out people can effectively weaponize evangelist sympathies to corrode Trumpian candidates' platforms, an entirely new world of possibilities might open up, for Democrats and radical right-wingers alike.

THE GHOST OF BENAZIR

confronting the legacy of Pakistan's "princess"

BY **MEHR NADEEM**

BABAR AWAN'S FACE flashed on television screens across Pakistan and around the world. Drenched in sweat and surrounded by masses of whimpering bodies, he looked straight at the camera and began to speak. Benazir Bhutto, former prime minister of Pakistan, had been rushed to the Rawalpindi General Hospital after a shooting and bombing at a campaign rally.

Awan had just spoken to Benazir's doctor on the phone. His voice broke as he stumbled to finish his words, further upsetting the shell-shocked masses. Sirens sounded in the background, and paramedics tended to the injured amid the bodies of 24 people killed by the explosion.

"Mauterma Benazir shaheed ho gayi hain," Awan declared.

She has been martyred.

Benazir Bhutto was assassinated that day, on December 27, 2007. Ten years later, the question of her legacy and the mystery of her murder both loom large in Pakistan.

After spending eight years in self-imposed exile, Benazir—who served as Pakistan's first female prime minister in the 1980s and 1990s—returned to her homeland just in time for the 2008 national elections. She had struck a deal with the incumbent president, strongman General Pervez Musharraf: With corruption charges against her dropped, she was allowed to re-enter the political arena. The U.S. and United Kingdom had previously backed Mushar the country triumphant, intent on gripping the moment of political uncertainty to displace Musharraf from power and

"She has been mar-tyred."

make herself prime minister once again.

Benazir was the first woman democratically elected to lead a Muslim nation. She rose to prominence after the execution of her father, ex-prime minister Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto, at the hands of the brutal military dictator General Zia-ul-Haq. As an ardent opponent of Zia's regime who was herself imprisoned and exiled, Benazir was lionized as an emblem of Pakistan's democratic struggle.

Perhaps for this reason, she and her supporters painted her 2007 return as a key step toward restoring normalcy in a nation facing what they called the "critical threat" of Islamic extremism. Benazir's anti-fundamentalist positioning infuriated the Taliban. She landed in Karachi wearing what appeared to be a bulletproof vest; she now had both the country's leader and largest terrorist group set against her.

Surrounded by cheering crowds and armed police, Benazir made her way from the airport toward the location of a scheduled rally. She never got there. Two bombs exploded in the vicinity of her motorcade, and more than 180 people died. Benazir herself was left unscathed.

Soon afterward, Indian journalist Barkha Dutt asked Benazir in a television interview whether the Taliban's threats on her life had scared her.

"I believe that life and death are in God's hands," Benazir replied, "and I believe that nobody can be killed until their time is up."

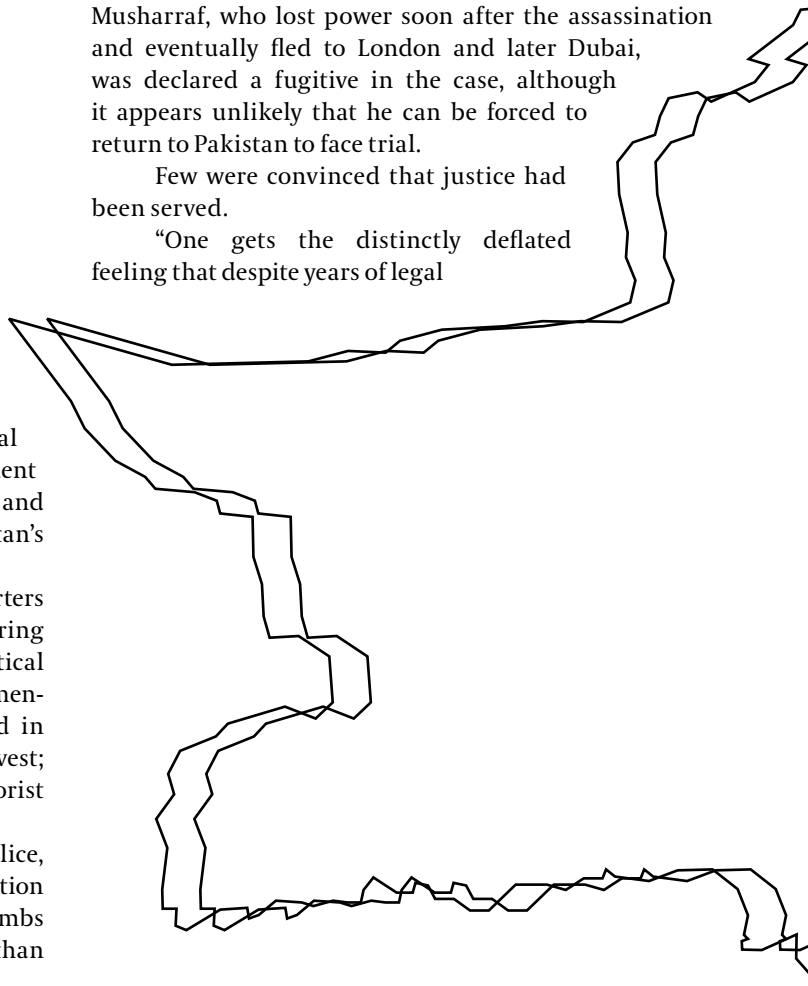
On December 27, she held another mass rally in Rawalpindi National Bagh. The roaring chants of her supporters, "Jeay jeay Bhutto!" (*Long live Bhutto!*), continued as she exited the arena in her bulletproof white Land Cruiser.

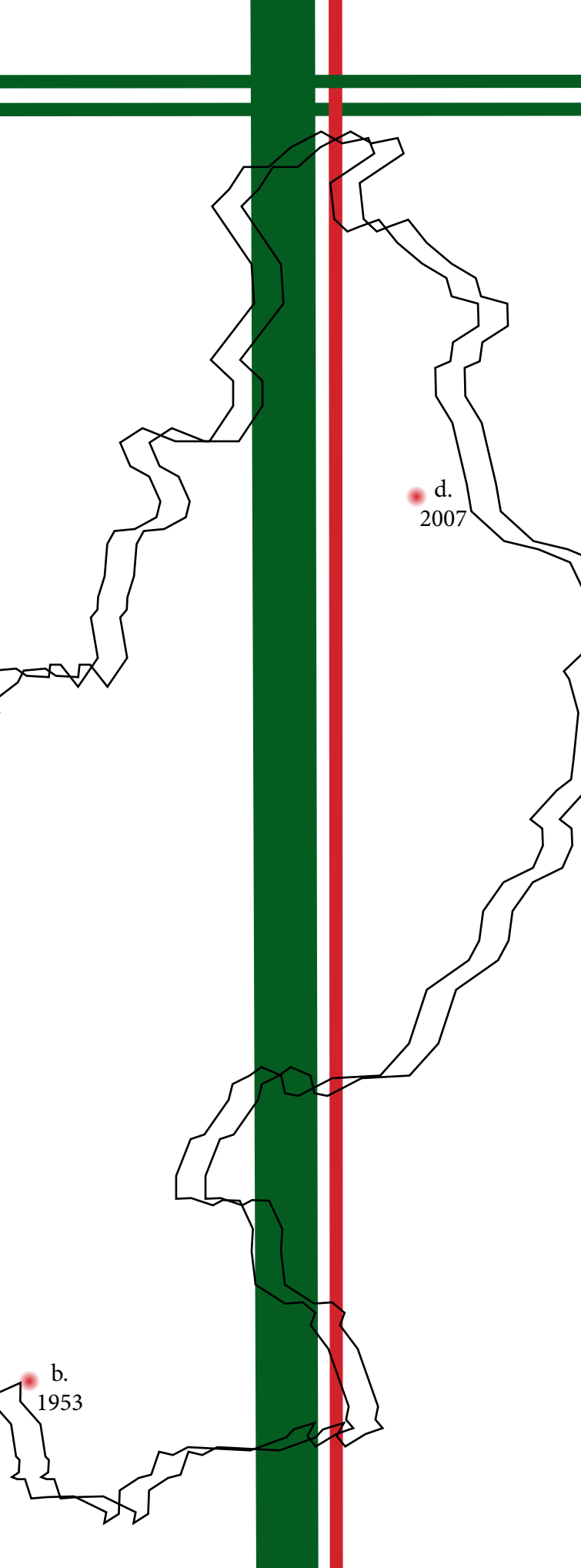
A few minutes later, she opened the vehicle's roof hatch and stood up in the car to wave at the crowds. As she greeted supporters gathered around her, a man within three meters of Benazir shot at her three times and then detonated his suicide vest. Her time was up.

On August 31, 2017, Pakistan's anti-terrorism court announced its judgement on Benazir's murder. Five key suspects linked to the Pakistani Taliban were freed due to lack of evidence. Two police officers were sentenced to seven years in prison for negligence. And most notably, General Musharraf, who lost power soon after the assassination and eventually fled to London and later Dubai, was declared a fugitive in the case, although it appears unlikely that he can be forced to return to Pakistan to face trial.

Few were convinced that justice had been served.

"One gets the distinctly deflated feeling that despite years of legal





proceedings, we are left with more questions than answers," Asad Ladha, a High Court Advocate based in Islamabad, told *The Politic*. "However, given that the judge in the case was changed eight times and the special prosecutor in the case was killed in 2013, it is surprising that the proceedings have reached even this stage."

As early as October 2007, Benazir herself had suspicions that people in high places wanted her dead.

She wrote to her friend, American journalist Mark Siegel: "Nothing will, God willing, happen. Just wanted u [*sic*] to know that if it does in addition to the names in my letter to Musharraf of Oct 16th, I wld [*sic*] hold Musharraf responsible."

As news of Benazir's assassination spread, riots and public mourning erupted in streets all over Pakistan. Within hours, hundreds of cars were burnt and shops were looted.

When the elections Benazir had hoped to contest were finally held, Musharraf's party suffered a humiliating defeat. Benazir's supporters, who won the election, forced Musharraf to resign within months. One day after ceding power, the disgraced general left for London to start his period of exile.

On September 22, 2017, Musharraf finally responded to allegations of his involvement in Benazir's assassination. In a public video, he argued that it was in fact Asif Ali Zardari, Benazir's husband, who was responsible for her death.

Musharraf contended not only that Zardari had the capability to execute the assassinations but also that he had the most to gain. Prior to the murder, Zardari was often referred to as "Mr. Ten Percent" and had spent eight years in jail on corruption and murder charges. Widely viewed as a criminal, he probably could never have become president in 2008—had he not been widowed.

Ladha speculated, "One is left wondering whether the multiple failures on the part of the authorities perhaps reveals a more sinister and high stakes cover up."

As Pakistan follows the trials in this murder case and, in two months time, marks the tenth anniversary of Benazir Bhutto's untimely death, its people are forced to confront the murky legacy of a woman who undoubtedly changed the landscape of their country's politics.

TO HER SUPPORTERS, Benazir was a powerful symbol of feminine resistance and resilience. Appointed chairperson of her father's party, the Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP), upon the elder Bhutto's execution in 1979, she immediately captured the nation's sympathies.

She could be seen on television describing her last moments with her father. "I said that I'd like to hug my father goodbye...they wouldn't even open the cell doors for me to kiss him goodbye."

"democracy is embedded not in an individual, but in the collective consciousness of a people."

When she won the 1988 elections to succeed General Zia, an Islamist responsible for importing Saudi-style Wahhabism to Pakistan, Benazir represented an abrupt shift in the country's image that was patently felt and remembered.

Her legacy is narrated with the language of democracy; she often fought against political norms. As a Sindhi, Shia woman—someone who would have been a second-class citizen in Zia's Pakistan—her prominence in a political sphere dominated by Punjabi, Sunni men was notable in and of itself.

Hasan Hanif '18, a Pakistani student at Yale, told *The Politic* that Benazir's most enduring quality was her nationwide appeal.

"She was the last national leader that we had in the country," Hanif said. "She managed to win elections from all over the country; a person who was appreciated in some capacity in every province."

But many critics bristle at the common characterization of Benazir as a democracy-loving feminist. Jemima Khan, a British-Pakistani journalist, famously argued that Benazir was a "kleptocrat in a Hermès scarf" who lacked authentic relevance. To Khan, Benazir—intelligent, beautiful, impeccably dressed, and equipped with a smooth English accent—was sent off from Oxford and Harvard, thinking she was carrying the torch of Western enlightenment to Pakistan.

Brooke Allen, who wrote Benazir's biography *Favored Daughter,* described to *The Politic* how the legacy of Benazir in the West has been rose-tinted.

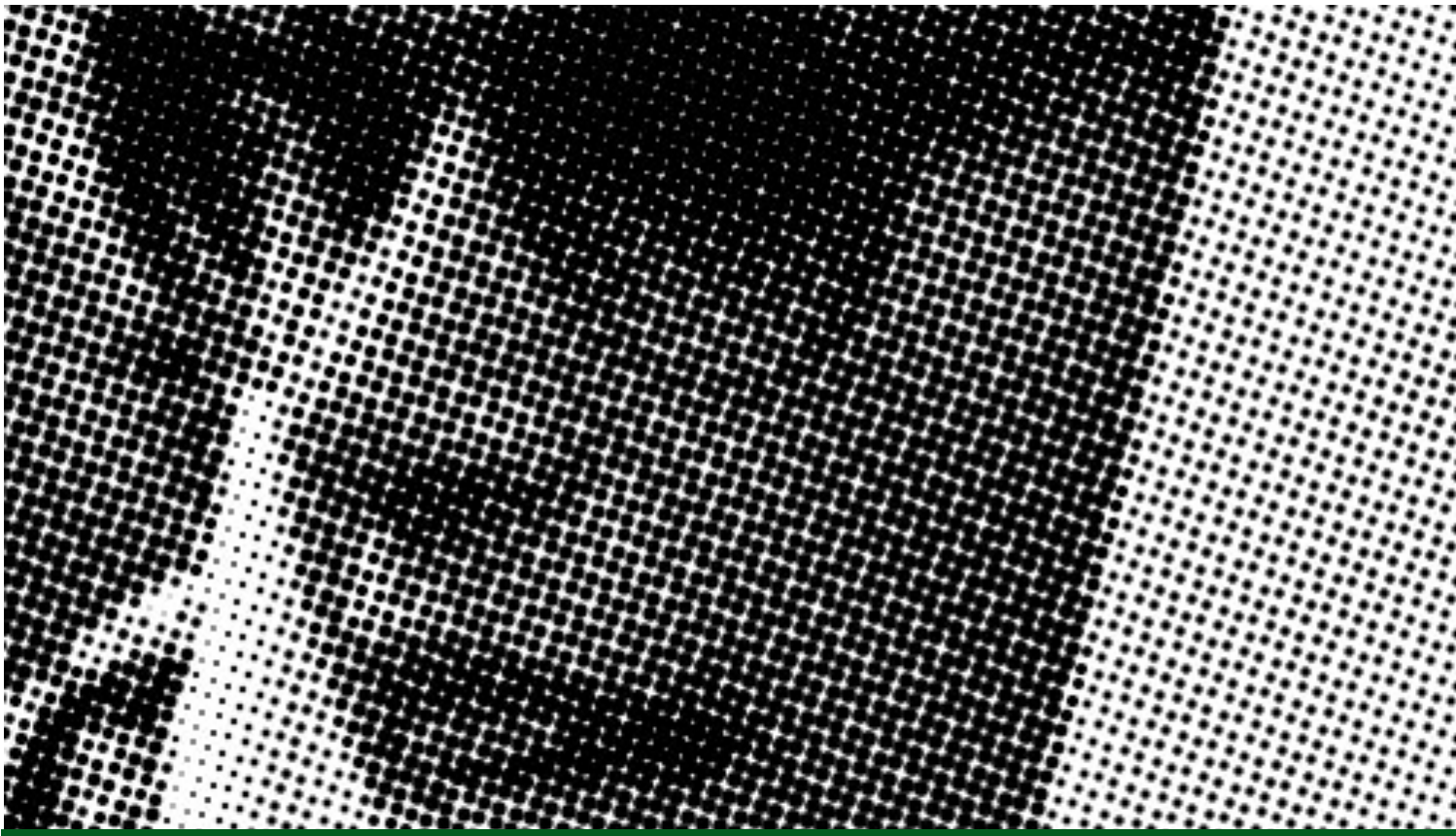
"They don't remember her flaws," Allen said. "They remember this attractive educated woman leader of Pakistan."

To her opponents, Benazir's status as an emblem of democracy and feminism existed mainly in the imaginations of the British and Americans. Her reality for Pakistanis was perhaps more simple—she was the daughter of a beloved, popular ex-prime minister.

Hanif told *The Politic*, "The whole fascination there is with South Asia is that we seem to have adapted into a twentieth century notion of democratic rule, but the language and imagery used is still that of dynastic power. *We use a colonial, imperial rhetoric to advance a twentieth century idea of democratic politics.*"

Khan has also accused Benazir of using her gender to manipulate her public persona, stating sarcastically, "I loved her answer to David Frost when he asked how many millions she had in her Swiss bank account. [Benazir said,] 'David, I think that's a very sexist question.'"

Finally, Benazir's legacy is defined by the family that she left behind. While her daughters have become involved



in apolitical charity work, her son Bilawal is now the chairperson of the PPP. A student at Oxford at the time of Benazir's death, he was given three years to complete his degree prior to assuming the party leadership.

Bilawal has had a mixed welcome into Pakistani politics. To some extent, the Bhuttos' tradition of dynastic politics has become institutionalized: The PPP's rhetoric has become, as Hanif noted, that "they are a party that has constantly given their lives for the sake of the common man."

Thus, for many, Bilawal's political involvement is commendable given the tragic history of his family. But Bilawal—who does not speak Urdu fluently—embodies and accentuates the "elitist" critique that was often directed at his mother, sullying Benazir's public image.

It is a curious thing that a woman admired in life as a strong female leader now finds her legacy largely in the hands of men. It is men who decide whether her murderers will face justice, just as it is her husband and her son, not her daughters, who are defining Pakistan's understanding of what the "Bhutto" name means.

Allen recalled how one of Benazir's peers at Oxford refused to read *Favored Daughter*.

"She didn't want to read my book," Allen told *The Politic*. "She loved Benazir, and she knew that she was flawed, and she knew that she hadn't been a good political figure in the end of her career—but she still retained that image of [Benazir] being someone who was extremely lovable."

To examine Benazir's life is to acknowledge that she was neither a hero nor a villain. And as Pakistan strives for democracy, her story is also a reminder that democracy is embedded not in an individual or a family name, but in the collective consciousness of a people.

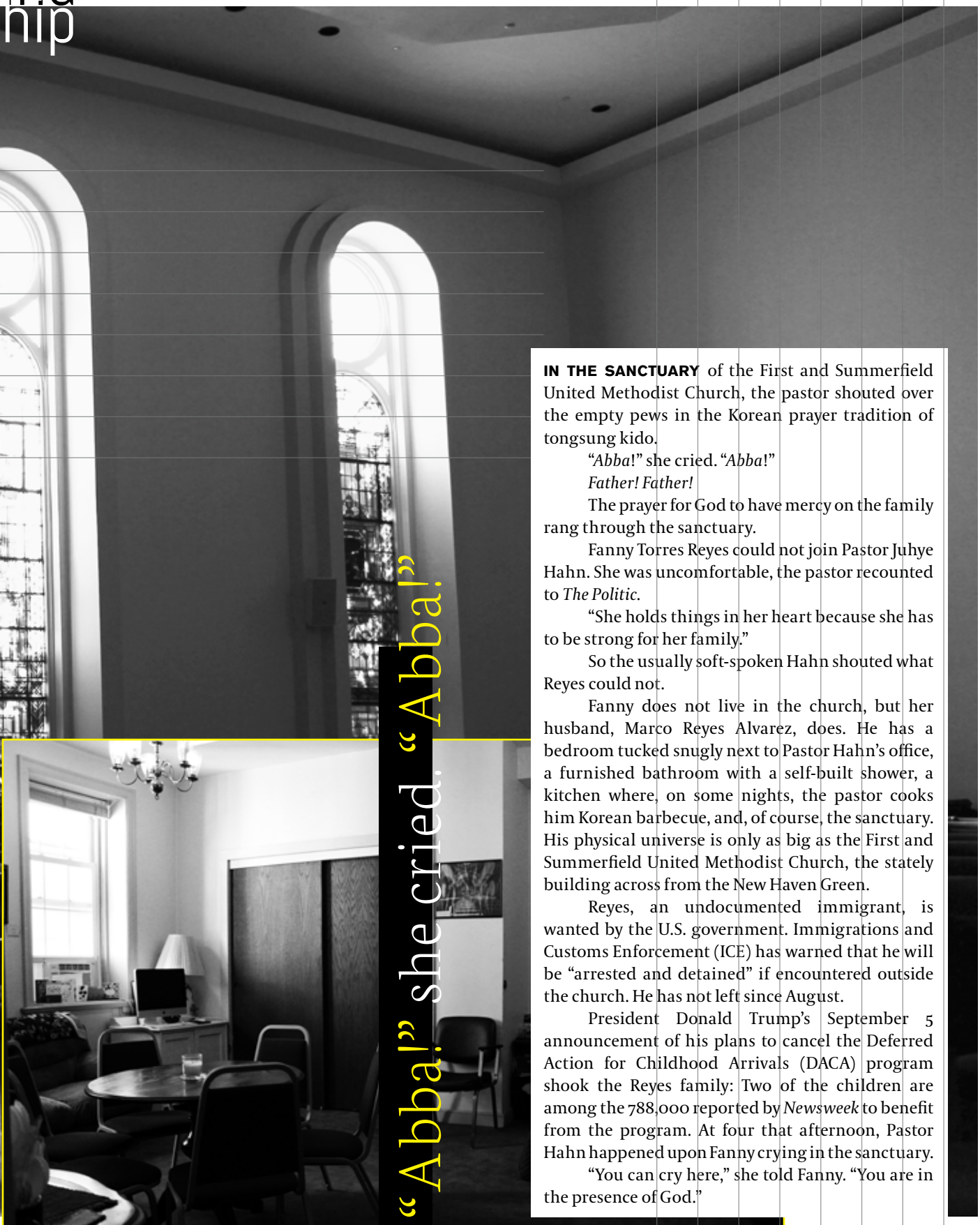
SACRED REFUGE

undocumented immigrants f
sanctuary in places of wors

BY **DANIEL YADIN**



find
hip



"Abba!" she cried. "Abba!"

IN THE SANCTUARY of the First and Summerfield United Methodist Church, the pastor shouted over the empty pews in the Korean prayer tradition of tongsung kido.

"*Abba*!" she cried. "*Abba*!"

Father! Father!

The prayer for God to have mercy on the family rang through the sanctuary.

Fanny Torres Reyes could not join Pastor Juhye Hahn. She was uncomfortable, the pastor recounted to *The Politic*.

"She holds things in her heart because she has to be strong for her family."

So the usually soft-spoken Hahn shouted what Reyes could not.

Fanny does not live in the church, but her husband, Marco Reyes Alvarez, does. He has a bedroom tucked snugly next to Pastor Hahn's office, a furnished bathroom with a self-built shower, a kitchen where, on some nights, the pastor cooks him Korean barbecue, and, of course, the sanctuary. His physical universe is only as big as the First and Summerfield United Methodist Church, the stately building across from the New Haven Green.

Reyes, an undocumented immigrant, is wanted by the U.S. government. Immigrations and Customs Enforcement (ICE) has warned that he will be "arrested and detained" if encountered outside the church. He has not left since August.

President Donald Trump's September 5 announcement of his plans to cancel the Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA) program shook the Reyes family: Two of the children are among the 788,000 reported by *Newsweek* to benefit from the program. At four that afternoon, Pastor Hahn happened upon Fanny crying in the sanctuary.

"You can cry here," she told Fanny. "You are in the presence of God."

FIRST AND SUMMERFIELD is part of a burgeoning community of New Haven places of worship that offer sanctuary to undocumented immigrants targeted for deportation by ICE. But only two New Haven churches—First and Summerfield, led by Pastor Hahn, and Iglesia de Dios Pentecostal, under Pastor Hector Luis Otero—have actually hosted an undocumented immigrant. Several other places of worship, including Congregation Mishkan Israel, a synagogue in Hamden led by Rabbi Herbert Brockman, have expressed their readiness to give sanctuary to those in need. Already, half a dozen undocumented immigrants in the New Haven area have contacted Congregation Mishkan Israel to express their interest in entering sanctuary.

Sanctuary churches and synagogues are able to take advantage of a directive issued by ICE in 2011 that prohibits agents from enforcing immigration law in "sensitive locations," including schools, hospitals, and places of worship. This policy, according to the agency, is meant to ensure that undocumented immigrants are able to use the services of these facilities "without fear or hesitation."

Despite this policy, *ThinkProgress* and the *Los Angeles Times* reported that ICE has detained undocumented immigrants at or near schools. Moreover, the sensitive locations policy, a simple memorandum from the director of ICE, could be easily reversed by another memo or executive order.

Places of worship were protecting undocumented immigrants long before the existence of the sensitive locations policy. The sanctuary movement first developed in the 1980s, when places of worship housed Central American refugees, most from El Salvador and Guatemala, who were traveling through the U.S. to get to Canada. Back then, sanctuary congregations ran covert operations. They usually served as stopping points where a migrant could eat, sleep, and rest safely for a few days, but not stay much longer.



Today, the sanctuary movement mainly serves undocumented immigrants who already live in the U.S. and have been affected by the recent increase in deportation orders. In the first six months of Trump's presidency, courts issued 31 percent more deportation orders than they had over the same period last year.

Nury Chavarria, a resident of Norwalk, CT, was the target of one of those orders. This summer, she became the first undocumented immigrant to seek sanctuary in a New Haven church.

Chavarria fled her native Guatemala 24 years ago and has lived in the U.S. since. On June 20, ICE informed her that she would have to "self-deport," meaning she would need to buy her own one-way plane ticket to Guatemala, drive to the airport, and leave the country within the month. But in the early hours of

"You can cry here," she told Fanny. "You are in the presence of God."



July 21, rather than report to Newark Liberty Airport for a 5:30 AM Guatemala-bound flight, Chavarria, her nine-year-old daughter in tow, decided to seek sanctuary.

Rabbi Brockman, of Congregation Mishkan Israel, told *The Politic* that he and five other religious leaders had received personal assurances from ICE officers that the agency would continue to abide by the sensitive locations memorandum despite the new administration's deportation zeal. But local sanctuaries still face the practical challenge of actually taking someone in.

"None of us had really prepared for this," recalled Rabbi Brockman. "We [faith leaders] had talked about it, we had done studies, we had done meetings." But when the time came for Chavarria to enter Iglesia de Dios Pentecostal, he said, "they were not ready."

Most places of worship are not equipped to host people for extended, indefinite periods of time. Reyes, a talented carpenter, built himself a shower in the bathroom at First and Summerfield. In Mishkan Israel, an undocumented immigrant would have to share the basement with the 95 children enrolled in the synagogue's daycare. Iglesia de Dios Pentecostal could only host Chavarria for a short-term stay.

The leadership of First and Summerfield unanimously decided to become a sanctuary church before Pastor Hahn started there in July.

"They didn't know what that meant. People wanted to help out," she told *The Politic*. "We are learning as we are actually doing it."

Supporters of sanctuary can protect undocumented immigrants in ways beyond physically hosting them. Faith leaders sometimes accompany immigrants to their ICE hearings, where officers decide whether or not to issue an order of deportation. Though accompaniers are not allowed to speak during the hearings, ICE officers are generally responsive to their presence, according to Rabbi Brockman. By his account, every accompaniment has resulted in the granting of a stay.

Communities can help undocumented immigrants before they are forced to enter sanctuary. Earlier this year, a Korean immigrant from Norwalk almost moved into Mishkan Israel but managed to stave off deportation by other means. After campaigners sent letters to the court and several hundred supporters converged on her Roman Catholic church for a prayer service in the immigrant's honor, the presiding immigration judge granted the woman a stay.

Sanctuary congregations offer undocumented immigrants more basic forms of support, too. Volunteers deliver groceries to Reyes; community members have raised money for his living expenses.

To hear Hahn describe it, granting someone sanctuary is a singular emotional experience. She says love drove her to open the doors of First and Summerfield.

"I don't think Jesus asked if you have an ID or the right document to receive food or healing grace," she said. "He just saw the need of the people. So, for us, we saw someone crying, someone needing shelter, and that's what we do."

Not all Christians appear to share Pastor Hahn's interpretation of the Bible. According to Pew Research Center estimates, 58 percent of Christians voted for Trump, who ran on a virulently anti-immigrant platform. During the campaign he pledged to expel "bad hombres" from the country and promised to "create a new special deportation task force" within ICE.

At First and Summerfield, Pastor Hahn has settled into a comfortable, quasi-domestic relationship with Marco Reyes. His living space is next to her office, separated by a wall thin enough to hear through. Hahn and Reyes cook meals and attend Sunday services together, where they share bread and grape juice. To Pastor Hahn, "he's like a part of the family."

First and Summerfield stands on unsteady legal ground. While no law prohibits churches from offering sanctuary to undocumented immigrants, it is unlawful to harbor a fugitive. In July, ICE declared Chavarria a fugitive from justice, forcing Iglesia de Dios Pentecostal to prove that it was hosting a fugitive temporarily rather than harboring one long-term. To this end, the church held a press conference on the day of Chavarria's entry into sanctuary. Church leaders reasoned that publicizing her stay would negate any claims of "harboring." In the end, no charges were filed against the church.



"Truth is really simple. If we add more things, it can be complicated."

A critical resource sanctuary congregations can offer, aside from food and lodging, is time. Entry to sanctuary brings a reprieve from the threat of deportation and allows an undocumented immigrant to mount a legal defense from a position of physical safety. In lucky cases, publicity might attract prominent lawyers.

For Chavarria, her week in sanctuary proved crucial to her ability to stay in the United States. While 200 people and a salsa band gathered for daily rallies in front of Iglesia de Dios Pentecostal, attorneys from the Yale Law Immigration Clinic were hard at work proving that Chavarria's 24 year-old asylum claim had been wrongly denied.

Chavarria originally applied for asylum along with her father and brother, who had escaped from Guatemala with her. Chavarria's brother and father asked for asylum at a court in New York and received it. But in Massachusetts, Chavarria was not so lucky: The court denied her request, and she has spent the following two and a half decades living in the U.S. as an undocumented immigrant.

When Yale Law attorneys highlighted this discrepancy before an immigration judge, Chavarria received a temporary stay, and her asylum case was reopened. An hour later, Chavarria was free to leave Iglesia de Dios Pentecostal.

Granting sanctuary can provoke a host of religious and ethical questions as well as legal ones. Pastors and rabbis may face congregants who are hostile to the idea of facilitating defiance against the U.S. government, uncomfortable with a stranger living in their place of worship, or simply unaware of the theological basis for sanctuary.

Pastor Hahn feels lucky that the vast majority of her 30 to 40 regular churchgoers support the decision to host Reyes. But Rabbi Brockman, whose synagogue has historically been active in social justice struggles, recently had a member quit because he "couldn't stand to sit through one more political speech." (Diplomat that he is, the rabbi quickly persuaded the man to return.)

Granting sanctuary to an undocumented immigrant has been complicated for Pastor Hahn in other, more personal ways. She is in the process of reframing her theology to accommodate issues like immigration that are, on their face, not obviously religious. It is important for her, she said, to base her actions in faith and her teachings in scripture, and she prays harder now than she did before.

According to Joyce Anne Mercer, a professor at the Yale Divinity School, the sanctuary movement has biblical precursors. In an interview with *The Politic*, she cited examples from the Hebrew Bible, such as the establishment of cities of refuge for mistaken murderers and the story of Adonijah, son of King David, who found sanctuary at an altar after angering his brother, Solomon. She also referenced the history of the Israelites, who, having been "strangers in the land of Egypt," are enjoined to grant outsiders the same love they have for their own people.

She also recognized the spirit of the sanctuary movement in the New Testament.

"The Christian gospels include multiple stories of Jesus enjoining followers to embody a new kind of love for their neighbors," she said. "One that redefines the neighbor from those who are nearby or like themselves, to see a neighbor instead as anyone in need."

Ever since Marco Reyes moved in, some of the country's most divisive debates—on the role of religion in public life, on what this nation owes immigrants, on living undocumented in the U.S.—have come to life in the staid white-columned church on College Street.

But Pastor Hahn looks past the complications.

"Some people can criticize us," she said. "But, for me, that's just how I interpret how to love our neighbor."

As she spoke, the voices of Marco Reyes and his attorney carried through the thin dividing wall into her office. They were strategizing his legal defense, probably, but Spanish and legalese rendered the conversation largely indecipherable.

"For me, truth is really simple. If we add more things, it can be complicated," Pastor Hahn said, her voice barely rising above a whisper.

On her desk lies a marked-up printout from Philippians. The book is a Prison Epistle, written by the Apostle Paul while in confinement.

On the other side of her wall is Marco Reyes, waiting.

Not Just Privilege, But Responsiblity

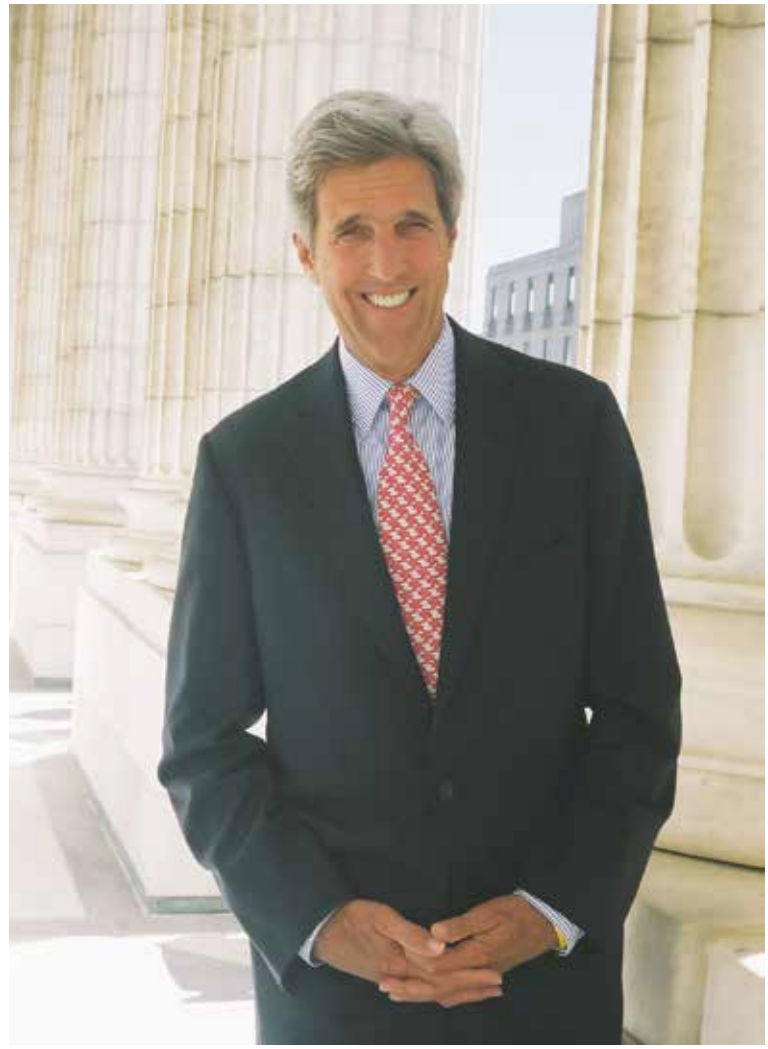
I'm proudly idealistic—even stubbornly so—about our role, and our responsibility.

BY **JOHN F. KERRY**

THIS IS BACK TO SCHOOL season—for you, and for me. Fifty-five years ago, I walked onto this campus as a freshman full of questions, with a lot to learn. I'm back at Yale today, with even more questions and a lot I hope we can learn together.

I know there's something some people like to dismiss as quaint or even anachronistic about a place like Yale contributing to a world as complicated as the one we share today. But I'm proudly idealistic—even stubbornly so—about our role, and our responsibility.

It's stamped in Yale's DNA. 2017 marks the 100th anniversary of America's entry into World War I, and right here a group of students who had formed the first Yale flying club vol-



unteered to become America's first naval aviation unit. They were our eyes in the skies—scouting enemy troop movements, locating mines, tracking submarines. On November 14, 1916, the *Yale Daily News* said they were doing the "work of the pioneer."

Some gave their lives—all because they believed they had a responsibility to country—to a cause bigger than any of them as individuals. One hundred years later, service and citizenship remain an unalterable thread in the very fabric of this university.

But citizenship also means a responsibility to ask tough questions about tough issues, and responsibility, after all, is also stamped in the DNA of this university. Here, when you're handed your diploma, President Salovey doesn't say what is said at most schools—that your degree admits you to all its "rights and privileges." At Yale, they say your degree admits you to all its "rights and responsibilities."

That responsibility includes participation in the hard debates about hard issues beyond the privilege and comfort that often accompany a world class education. My college years were a time when we were starting as a country to wrestle with some tough questions—and we were beginning a great transformation.

I was a freshman when the Cuban Missile Crisis brought us to the brink of nuclear war. I was a sophomore playing in the Harvard-Yale soccer game when the young president who had inspired us was assassinated. I was a junior when civil rights marchers were savagely attacked on Selma's Edmund Pettus Bridge. I remember vividly seeing the images on my TV set of Bull Connor's police dogs menacing peaceful civil rights protesters, and something clicked then about unfinished business at home. A young civil rights leader named Allard Lowenstein came to Yale and challenged us to get involved—to get out of our comfort zone and join the fight for civil rights and justice in our own country.

Then came the war that was beginning to loom over our post-graduation decisions—and little did we realize how something that at one point seemed so simple—a great challenge out of President Kennedy's Inaugural Address to bear any burden—would in fact take the form of a complex decades-long fight that it turned out wasn't about America but was about Vietnam and the Vietnamese.

What's that have to do with a responsibility to get out of our comfort zone and ask tough questions today?

Today, we face a world that—everywhere we look—is manifestly much more complicated, less hierarchical, where non-state actors play a central role—where disturbing images and outright lies can circle the globe in an instant, where dangers like climate change, terrorism, and disease do not respect borders, and where tribal and sectarian hatreds are as prominent as they've been in centuries.

And I think this campus—all of us—needs to actively wrestle with that complexity.

With complexity always comes an easy temptation to wish the world away. The desire to turn

At Yale, they say your degree admits you to all its "rights and responsibilities."

Outright lies can circle the globe in an instant...

dangers like climate change, terrorism, and disease do not respect borders.

inward and shut out the world may be especially seductive in an era as complicated as this. For some, the temptation to find refuge or recrimination in "alternative facts" is also powerful. But it can't be at Yale, and it's not a choice that the most prosperous and powerful nation on the planet can afford to make.

Here's just one challenge I hope we can come to understand—and help navigate, with truth. The world is witnessing a wave of technological transformation that is on the scale of the industrial revolution, but happening at a digital pace. The only thing that isn't coming at us faster and faster is the ability of governance worldwide to respond.

Technology—not trade—is the principal reason we lost 85 percent of the 5.6 million manufacturing jobs hemorrhaged in the first decade of this century. It's bad enough that we haven't yet solved the jobs crisis in West Virginia and parts of Ohio. But if our institutions can't build consensus and respond to the demand of Americans for jobs today, how will we ever do it in a time when artificial intelligence and robotics kick in and five times that number of jobs disappear twice as fast?

And this isn't just happening here, it's a global challenge. It is happening everywhere and disrupting politics everywhere. Yale graduates will always do well in any economy—but if we aren't helping build an economy—and governance—where everyone can do well, where there's shared prosperity, then we aren't living up to both words on those Yale diplomas: not just privilege, but responsibility.

So, there are debates to be joined—in earnest. Complexities to challenge us. Let's have at it. As a recovering politician myself, I can tell you it's easy for politicians to talk about American exceptionalism. But we're not an exceptional country because we say we are—we're exceptional because we do exceptional things. Yale, let's have at it.

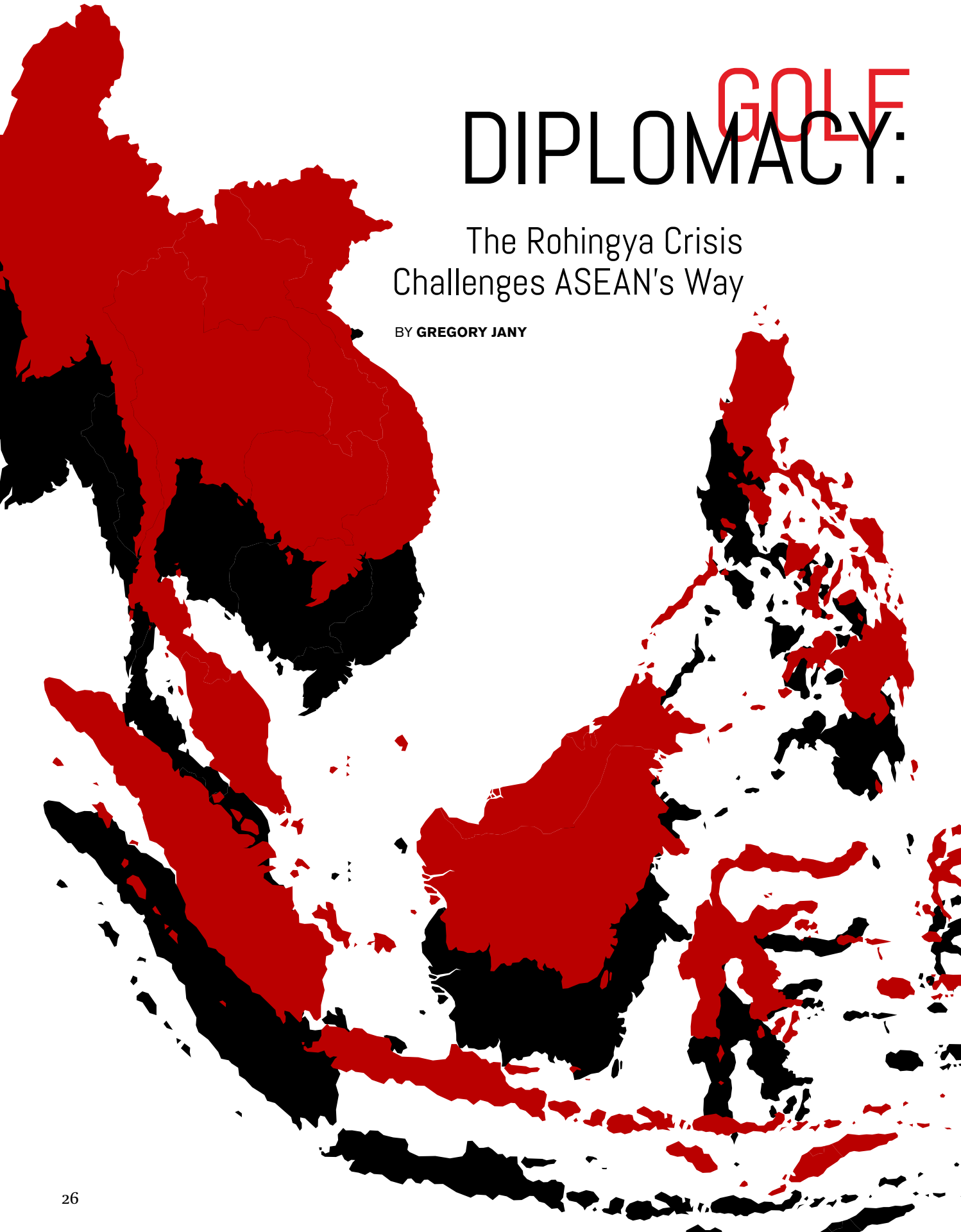
The 68th Secretary of State of the United States, John F. Kerry '66, is Yale's Distinguished Fellow for Global Affairs and is the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace's Visiting Distinguished Statesman. He is teaching a seminar at Yale in the Fall semester.

The only thing that isn't coming at us faster and faster is the ability of governance worldwide to respond.

GOLF DIPLOMACY:

The Rohingya Crisis Challenges ASEAN's Way

BY **GREGORY JANY**



NASIMA KHATUN lived a quiet life before Myanmar's military barged into her village. Brandishing their guns, soldiers fired in all directions. Nasima ran. She fled to the jungle, hid, and waited. It was not until later that she learned her husband had been shot dead.

"I felt helpless and afraid," Khatun told *Al Jazeera* in an interview in September 2017. "I cried and cried the whole way so my neighbours took pity on me and paid for our boat trip across to Bangladesh."

Khatun is one of the 370,000 Rohingya who crossed the Bangladeshi border from Myanmar's Rakhine State. The Rohingya are a stateless Muslim minority that are not recognized by Myanmar's government. The United Nations considers them one of the world's most persecuted people.

Violence has intensified in the fall of 2017, ever since the military launched a crackdown against alleged attacks by Rohingya insurgents.

Members of the international community have denounced the government's lack of response to the crackdown. Aung Sang Suu Kyi received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1999 for her opposition to Myanmar's military dictatorship, but her refusal to denounce what the United Nations is calling ethnic cleansing has tainted her reputation.

The cries from abroad have been loud.

United Nations Secretary-General António Guterres called on Myanmar to halt its military campaign, giving Aung Sang Suu Kyi, the de facto leader of Myanmar's government, "one last chance" to end the attack. Archbishop Emeritus Desmond Tutu, a South African anti-apartheid leader and fellow Nobel Peace Prize winner, wrote that he was "breaking [his] vow to remain silent on public affairs" to issue a plea to Aung Sang Suu Kyi to end the violence. The European Parliament has even threatened to pursue sanctions.

Closer to home, the Rohingya waited for a call to action by the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN), a regional grouping of Myanmar's closest neighbors. That call never came.

"Why isn't ASEAN taking a role in trying to mediate the crisis?" asked Edith Terry '74, author, journalist, and adjunct business professor at the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology Business School, in an interview with *The Politic*.

Is it possible that ASEAN's unique structure hinders meaningful political action?

ASEAN was created in 1967 to broker disputes between Indonesia, the Philippines, and Malaysia. At the organization's founding, Adam Malik, then Indonesian Minister for Foreign Affairs, said that he hoped the group would foster "a region which [could] stand on its own feet, strong enough to defend itself against any negative influence from outside the region."

ASEAN's ten members—Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, and Vietnam—"[represent] an effort to bring together a very diverse set of countries and societies into a sense of shared regional identity," said Tom Pepinsky, associate professor of Government at Cornell University, in an interview with *The Politic*.

But, he continued "ASEAN baked into it a series of structural contradictions that prevent it from [doing] what it wants to do."

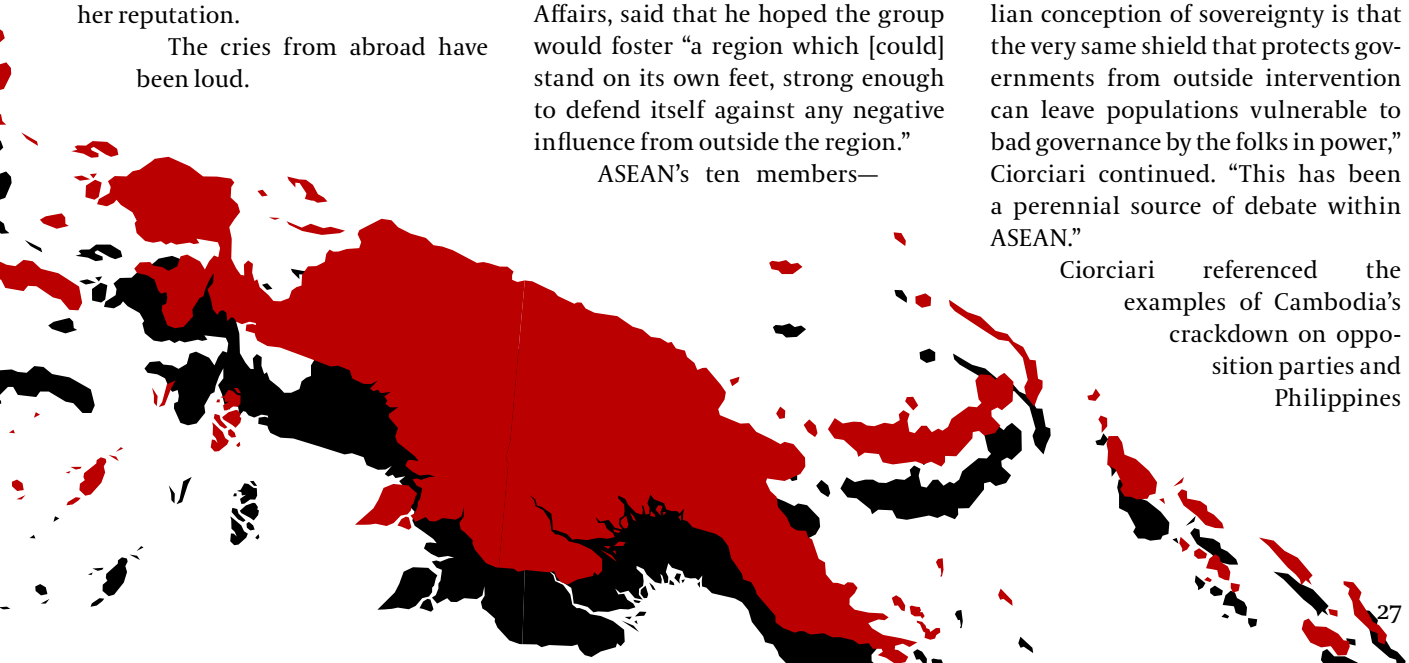
ASEAN's unique system of values, dubbed the "ASEAN Way," arose from its original vision and a shared history of colonialism.

"The idea of the ASEAN Way is to bring everyone along in a style of diplomacy that takes a lot of time, that requires a lot of rounds of consultations, and tries to build consensus, so the organization does not contribute to divisions among its members," John Ciorciari, associate professor and Director of the International Policy Center at the University of Michigan, told *The Politic*.

ASEAN requires the unanimous vote of its members for the organization to take action. This principle of non-interference emerged from the painful experience of colonialism in Southeast Asia.

"The downside of this Westphalian conception of sovereignty is that the very same shield that protects governments from outside intervention can leave populations vulnerable to bad governance by the folks in power," Ciorciari continued. "This has been a perennial source of debate within ASEAN."

Ciorciari referenced the examples of Cambodia's crackdown on opposition parties and Philippines





"The risk is that these big elephants, like China and the United States, might push the nations apart."
-Edith Terry

President Rodrigo Duterte's campaign against drugs. The Singaporean government, alongside those of Laos, Vietnam, and Cambodia, has refused to classify Myanmar's Rohingya crisis as an international issue that requires interference.

In these cases, the principle of non-interference functions as "both a constraint and excuse in terms of non-action in neighboring countries," according to Ciorciari.

This hands-off approach has driven academics like Pepinsky to call the organization "ineffectual."

"In many senses, [ASEAN is] somewhat of a disappointment," he said.

But others disagree.

"ASEAN has a different sort of profile and deliverables from classic Western institutions, but it has met the needs of itself over a long period of time," said Terry. "You know that slogan on people's t-shirts saying 'Keep calm and drink tea'? I think that's what ASEAN is about."

ASEAN's reputation for calm deliberation makes it an important forum for resolving regional disputes, a role that many credit with preventing major inter-state conflicts in the region. Organization members discuss major issues over golf.

"[A golf course] can be a meeting place, where people can come together in a relatively benign environment," said Terry. "After the meeting, they'll go play some golf. And on the golf course they'll have a productive conversation. You can call that ridiculous. You can say that it's a waste of time, but it is much better than their having no organizational framework at all."

Others like Rahimah Abdulrahim, Yale Greenberg World Fellow '15 and Executive Director of the Habibie Center, a think tank based in Jakarta, argue that ASEAN gives its members a shared identity.

"Had [Indonesia and Myanmar] not been part of ASEAN together, had Myanmar not joined when it did, or had it remained at just the original five [Indonesia, Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore, and Thailand], I don't think we would've felt the same sense of responsibility," she said in an interview with *The Politic*.

Recently, Indonesian President Joko Widodo held talks with Aung San Suu Kyi after which the Indonesian government sent 34 tons of aid, including tents, rice, sugar, and sanitation supplies to Rohingya refugee camps in Bangladesh.

Abdulrahim, who is from Indonesia, emphasized the importance of proximity and joint involvement in ASEAN as a motivation for this aid. "We feel such a large responsibility towards Myanmar, because the conflict is a part of our community. It is in our backyard."

Abdulrahim also argued for the need to build relationships and a sense of regional community outside of the capital cities, where citizens from poor and rural communities tend to reside.

"Sometimes we forget how big our countries are. Sometimes it's just easy to talk about Jakarta, Kuala Lumpur, speaking to Bangkok. It's not Bojonegoro, to Kuala Terengganu, to Marawi," said Abdulrahim, distinguishing between the major cities and the lesser-known regions of Indonesia, Malaysia, and the Philippines.

ASEAN has more problems to solve than just those of Myanmar.

"ASEAN's weaknesses may mean that it's vulnerable to [becoming] irrelevant," said Ciorciari. "For example, in the South China Sea issue, there is a tendency of the Chinese government to adopt a strategy of bilateralism, where they negotiate one-on-one with individual countries and hamstring the ability of ASEAN itself from negotiating their issues."

In the past, ASEAN has struggled to adopt a joint stance on the South China Sea, with Myanmar, Cambodia, and Laos—all allies of China—opposed to interfering in the issue. China and the United States are not members of ASEAN, but both nations routinely participate in its conferences.

"The risk is that these big elephants, like China and the United States, might push the nations apart," noted Terry.

The organization's key challenge, says Abdulrahim, is to utilize its resources and take concrete action.

"ASEAN needs to remember that it has a seat at the table and has a role in maintaining international order," he said.

As of today, however, ASEAN's only acknowledgement of the crisis is a statement at the United Nations General Assembly expressing "concern" and "deepest condolences."

At least for now, it seems that ASEAN's leaders are content with "keeping calm and drinking tea."

NEXT STOP... YALE: CHINESE TOURISM ON CAMPUS

BY **SAMMY WESTFALL**



PHOTO BY **SAMMY WESTFALL**

"THE STATUE OF LIBERTY, The White House, Niagara Falls... Yale."

Non Shao, a guide for the Mayi Tour Group, read aloud highlights of the group's seven-day tour itinerary. He waved an orange flag to catch the eye of a boy in a Harvard sweatshirt who had wandered off. Behind the guide, the crowd of cap-clad, selfie-snapping tourists from China rubbed Theodore Dwight Woolsey's golden foot. Some were years past viable admission-process age, but that didn't stop them.

China's educational tourism industry is booming, and universities around the world are experiencing the impact. The industry was worth an estimated 4.5 billion U.S. dollars in 2016 alone. Chinese citizens of all ages are willing to spend from 200 to more than 8,000 dollars to visit elite college campuses.

Though now wildly popular, Chinese educational tourism is a relatively new phenomenon.

The Chinese tourism industry hardly existed at all 15 years ago, due to strict travel controls and a weak domestic economy. According to the China National Tourism Administration, in 2007, 31 million Chinese tourists traveled out of the country; in 2016, that number hit 127 million. China's economic boom has made international travel accessible for millions, inspiring a newfound desire to explore the world.

David Youtz, executive director of the Yale-China Association, has observed the expansion of the Chinese tourism industry firsthand.

"Traveling is seen as exciting; it is seen as being cosmopolitan," Youtz told *The Politic*. "It is seen as being modern to say that you've been to Paris, or Tokyo, New York or Australia."

Now, New Haven makes the list, too.

From his office on the second floor of the Yale-China Association, Youtz has a bird's eye view of Temple Street, where many tour groups park their buses. The influx of Chinese tourists to Yale has caused the organization to restructure and move offices upstairs to create space for a museum that will showcase Yale's long history with China.

Youtz looks forward to opening the museum's doors to visitors within the next two years.

"I think it will be a benefit to Yale," he said. "People can come in, spend their time, and view the Yale-China story."

Rooted in centuries of history, this story spans many generations. Yung Wing, the first Chinese student to enroll in an American university, graduated from Yale in 1854. In addition to playing football and singing in the choir, Wing founded the Chinese Educational Mission, which brought 120 Chinese students to North American schools, including Yale. Wing's efforts to connect the university with China led to the creation of the Yale-China Association in 1901. Today, Yung Wing's legacy is reflected in the 300,000 Chinese students who attend American universities. According to the, they comprise one third of the international undergraduate population in the United States.

Huahao Zhou '21, a Yale student from Chongqing, China, spoke to *The Politic* about the impact of Wing's story on his educational aspirations.

"When I was 12, I watched a documentary called 'Yung Wing' that played on CCTV, the nation's state-run television station," Zhou said.

Yale's international prestige makes it a must-see landmark for many Chinese tourists.

"It is like a palace—a holy palace," Zhou added. "Even for me, I hadn't been to the United States before this, and even I wanted to see what Yale looked like."

Bohan Lou '20, the only student Yale has accepted from his Shanghai school, highlighted the prestige associated with a Yale degree in China.

"If you tell anyone in my city that you go to Yale, it will be automatically assumed that you are very intelligent, that you are one of the most elite," Lou noted in an interview with *The Politic*.

"In a minor way, yes, I am a celebrity," Lou continued. "When my friends got in, news stations interviewed them, there were articles written about them, they were invited to give talks—just because they got into Yale."

"The combined forces of parental pressure and an intense focus on test scores have driven many Chinese students away from the Chinese education system."

Chinese ranking culture largely contributes to the recent increase in tourism.

"They love to rank things, more than American society does," Youtz explained. "They are constantly ranking their own cities: the greenest city, the best food, the most polluted city. They'll literally have a list from one to 50, and you can see that your city is ranked, let's say, 37th."

"Americans don't look at it quite that way," Youtz continued. "But there is a readiness in Chinese to say: Yale is the number one, or Harvard is the number one school. That, rightly or wrongly, makes Yale seems like one of the most important universities in the world in the public imagination."

"In a minor way, yes, I am a celebrity."

"People here at Yale have good grades," remarked a tourist from Chongqing, China, in an interview with *The Politic*. "People at Yale will become famous in the world. If I study in Yale, I will be different than the others."

But the very impulse to rank that draws students to Yale also drives them away from the Chinese educational system.

"China has an extremely intense educational system," explained Youtz. "[Students] are not only ferociously competitive. Everyone knows their rank in their class. Whether you're 13th or second or 38th. There is terrible pressure on kids to pass tests."

Tourist Yuhan Chen described his fascination with the culture of freedom fostered at Yale and other American universities.

"You can sit on the grass. You can talk freely," Chen said in an interview with *The Politic*. She motioned toward a fierce spikeball game nearby, saying, "You can play all kinds of sports that you want."

Chinese and American universities differ in academics, too.

"In most Chinese universities, you cannot change your major," explained Carol Li Rafferty, Managing Director of Yale Center Beijing, in an interview with *The Politic*.

"It's kind of like once you are streamed into a philosophy major at whatever school, that's what you need to stick with," said Rafferty. "People are in that mindset of 'my future is decided at this point where I get streamed into a certain university and into a certain major and that defines the rest of my life.' That's where the pressure comes from."

In a way, this decisive moment occurs even before starting university. Referencing China's *Gaokao* exam, Rafferty explained, "The way it works in China is that you take the university entrance exam and depending on the score you get, it kind of changes your whole future."

The *Gaokao*, which translates literally from Chinese to "Big Test," lasts about nine hours, over a two-day period. This year, 9.8 million students took the exam. *The New York Times* reports that many children start studying for the high-stakes exam in elementary school.

"You take the *Gaokao* exam, and your score determines which university you can go to," Shuangyi Zhang '21 told The Politic. "Your life is dependent on that score. If you get the highest mark, you can go to the best university."

"As China, as a country, becomes more open," Zhou added, "children in China are beginning to realize that they are better suited for a more free American curriculum. Some parents also realize the problems with Chinese education system, and they want their children to be happy."

He added that, on the other hand, "Some parents also see life as a competition, and they always want their children to win."

"To [Chinese parents], education is viewed as the pathway to success," explained David Lau, Rafferty's New Haven counterpart at the Yale Center Beijing, in an interview with *The Politic*. "Education is the key that will unlock the future."

Speaking of the tourists at Yale, he added, "I think some parents want to visit to elite colleges hoping that their children will one day come here. Even if they don't bring their children to visit, it gives them the vision of what they want for their children in the future."

"There's a Chinese proverb that means 'you want your child to become a dragon,'" said Rafferty. "It's every parent's dream."

from CATHERINE THE GREAT to PUTIN

russia's tangled relationship with its muslim minority

BY **JACK McCORDICK**

THINGS KEPT GETTING worse for Ilyas Nikitin. Just hours after a deadly bomb attack rattled the St. Petersburg metro on April 3, 2017, Russian media circulated photographs of the suspected terrorist—a bearded, black-clad man wearing what appeared to be an Islamic prayer cap. Nikitin, a truck driver from provincial Russia, was shocked to see his own face flashing on television screens. After clearing his name with the police, Nikitin attempted to board a plane from Moscow to Ufa, the capital of his native region, but passengers recognized him and summarily kicked him off the flight. Later that week, Nikitin's boss fired him, allegedly at the behest of local government investigators.

Nikitin's story is not just a cautionary tale about the speed with which false rumors can spread. It also provides a glimpse into the fraught relationship between Russia's authorities and its Muslim population, against whom discrimination is commonplace.

Chechen separatists began to adopt unconventional and sometimes violent tactics, surprising Russian forces in ambushes and resorting to hostage attacks in mainland Russia.

Officially acknowledged as one of Russia's four founding religions, Islam is woven into the nation's cultural and historical fabric. Today, around 20 million Muslims currently live in Russia. In the nearly three decades since the collapse of the Soviet Union, the government has had a complex relationship with Russia's Muslim communities.

This relationship originated hundreds of years ago, with Catherine the Great.

"Catherine was the first to realize that Russia was no longer a homogenous country, that it was not just Slav Orthodox Christians," said Shireen Hunter, a professor at Georgetown's School of Foreign Service and the author of *Islam in Russia: The Politics of Identity and Security*, in an interview with *The Politic*. "She realized that somehow you have to bring these peoples in some kind of relationship and, eventually, [institute] not exactly control but definitely supervision of the state."

Catherine II's government skillfully co-opted Muslim elites to consolidate control over the empire's diverse Muslim population and bring the Muslim minority into the fold. But in some instances, Muslims opposed the state's efforts at assimilation and faced brutal responses.

Hunter explained that maintaining a balance between co-optation and oppression characterized the Russian state's relationship with the Muslim community until the twentieth century. At that point, the Soviet Union's policy of state-sponsored atheism momentarily threatened the delicate relationship between Russia and its Muslims.

But by the 1970s, Islamic practice had been revived in Central Asia and Muslim-majority areas. Like Russian governments before, the USSR came to tolerate Islam in order to preserve stability across its vast areas of control.

While the North Caucasus had been part of Russia for centuries, it was never fully integrated. After the collapse of the Soviet Union, Muslim-majority Chechnya, part of the North Caucasus region, declared its independence from Russia.

"You had this separate group [of Muslims] in the North Caucasus which was brought into the Russian empire in a very long, violent campaign in the nineteenth century," said Thomas Graham, former Director of Russian Affairs on the National Security Council and the current co-director of the Russian Studies Project at Yale, in an interview with *The Politic*.

The historical opposition to Russian control came to a head in the brutal First Chechen War of 1994-1996 as Russia moved to re-assert its authority over the region, which is predominantly Muslim. As civilian casualties mounted and reports of Russian atrocities became more common, Chechen separatists began to adopt unconventional and sometimes violent tactics, surprising Russian forces in ambushes and resorting to hostage attacks in mainland Russia. Chechen separatism remained powerful until 2009.

While Russia was ultimately able to control Chechnya

politically, it has still struggled to contain terrorism. Since 1992, nearly 4,000 Russians have died in almost 900 lethal terror attacks across the country. The April attack on the St. Petersburg Metro was another in a long line of attacks that began after the Chechen conflict.

Despite the recurrence of terrorist attacks, Putin has attempted to restore the delicate balance that once characterized the relationship between Russia and Muslim minority groups.

In an interview with *The Politic*, Michael Khodarkovsky, a professor of Russian history at Loyola University Chicago, compared the current administration's strategy to that of Catherine II's reign.

"I think what the Kremlin is doing now is exactly the same [as under Catherine II],"

"They want to be able to control the Muslims and make sure they are loyal."

Khodarkovsky has written several books examining the relationship between the expanding Russian state and the non-Christian peoples across its colonial frontier. "I think what the Kremlin is doing now is exactly the same [as under Catherine II]," he said. "They want to be able to control the Muslims and make sure they are loyal."

Since the beginning of his presidency, Vladimir Putin has prioritized engagement with Russia's various Muslim populations. In 2002, he made a well-publicized visit to the main mosque in Maykop, the capital city of the Republic of Adygea, during Ramadan celebrations. He and Vice President Dmitry Medvedev continue to visit mosques regularly, and Putin often publicly wishes Muslims well during Islamic holidays.

Despite Putin's efforts, though, the Russian government's relationship with Muslims remains complex. Hunter underscored the impossibility of forging relationships with a single, unified Muslim Russian community.

"We cannot and should not talk of Muslims as a monolith because, unfortunately, we tend to think that the people who proclaim Islam as their faith don't have other loyalties," she said. "That's not true, and in particular I think we have to keep in mind issues of ethnicity and ethnic and historical rivalries."

For Muslims in Russia, religion and ethnicity are inextricably linked.

"Russia, as an heir to an empire, has inherited all these complex ethno-territorial structures," Khodarkovsky noted. "The problem with Russia, and this is a very unique problem, certainly compared to any Western society, is that the ethnic minorities live in compact territorial enclaves."

Russia's Muslim population can be broken down into three distinct groups. Graham explained that native Muslim populations are concentrated in a set of semi-autonomous republics. These republics consist of the Volga-Ural region, which includes Tatarstan and Bashkortostan, and the North Caucasus, which includes Chechnya and Dagestan. A third group has developed in the megacities of mainland Russia.

These groups are not static. The last two decades have seen a new wave of Muslim arrivals in Russia. Economic problems have been partially responsible for the spike in immigration from Central Asia that began in the early 2000s, according to Graham. This influx has caused a host of problems for the Russian state.

"Even if the Russian government is trying to integrate the Muslim community into the Russian state and political system, the migrants that come from Central Asia are not Russian citizens," he said. "They're foreigners. They get exploited the way illegal immigrants get exploited all the world over."

Russia desperately needs cheap, migrant labor as its population ages and its workforce shrinks.

Andrew Movchan, director of the economic policy program at the Moscow Carnegie Center, explained in an interview with *Bloomberg*, "If you take out the migrants, who comprise 15 percent of the Russian workforce, it will be impossible to replace them."

But the influx of migrants has led to a marked rise in xenophobia across Russia.

"It's not dissimilar from the attitudes that you have in some parts of the United States, though we're dealing with a different migrant population as opposed to Russia," said Graham. "But we're dealing with the same sort of attitudes. You do need [the migrants], they do occupy an important niche in the economy, but you do also get the nativist reaction."

Putin's strategy has been an extension of the kind of co-optation and integration pioneered by Catherine II nearly three centuries ago.

Putin's alliance with the Eastern Orthodox Church has manifested primarily in his embrace of "traditional" values—his resistance to multiculturalism, radical feminism, gay rights, etc.—in the face of Western liberality gone wild. Values that also appeal to the Muslim community in Russia.

When asked if Muslims support Putin's embrace of traditional Orthodox values, Hunter said, "Muslims love it."

He continued, "On social issues, I think the Church and Muslim leadership will definitely agree and support Putin. Basically they want a more communitarian and more "moral' society."

"The Kremlin has largely succeeded in making Islam a solid pillar of Putin's system of governance, albeit one that's hardly been noticed outside of Russia," said Robert Crews, a professor of history at Stanford and an expert on Russia and Islam, in an article for the *World Politics Review*.

Putin is seeking political support in an unlikely place. But with an eye to history, it is not so unlikely after all.

"They're foreigners. They get exploited the way illegal immigrants get exploited all the world over."

When A Tree Falls in Yale's Forest

How Timber Helps Fund an Ivy League Endowment

BY **BRIAN LI**

DEEP IN THE FORESTS of New Hampshire, oaks and maples fall by the hundreds. Logging is not uncommon in these parts, but it is not usually done to support an Ivy League endowment. To the tune of buzzing chainsaws, Yale trades forests for lucrative returns.

Over the past 20 years, Yale has quietly purchased over 10,000 acres of forests that sprawl across New England. Rather than relying exclusively on traditional stocks, Yale's current Chief Investment Officer David F. Swensen has chosen to invest part of Yale's endowment in unorthodox assets, including natural resources. In the last few years, the pace of logging on Yale's land has increased dramatically. As the felled trees pile up, the question emerges: Is the university ignoring its commitment to environmental sustainability for the sake of higher returns on its endowment?

Swensen is hailed in investment circles for his pioneering investment strategy, which has elevated Yale's endowment to 25.4 billion dollars—the second largest of any university in the world. Yale's forest holdings are a crucial part of this success. They offer stable yields that have protected Yale from unexpected economic shocks, like the 2008 Recession. Over the past 20 years, the asset class has generated an average yearly return of 16.2 percent, compared to the 9.3 percent average yearly return on more traditional investments.

Yale does not oversee its forests directly, and instead contracts the work to a company called Wagner Forest Management. Among other administrative duties, Wagner is responsible for logging portions of the forest to collect marketable timber. But over the last four to five years, Wagner has become increasingly aggressive in its forest management strategy, clearcutting large swathes of Yale's forests.

Wayne Montgomery, the former owner of a logging company and a 40-year veteran of the forest industry, told *The Politic* that this increase in logging activity is a result of Yale's push for higher returns on its investment.

"I think part of their plan is to look at a 13 to 15 percent return on investment. But to do that on timber land you've got to be very, very aggressive in your management, and you have to throw sustainable forest management out of the window to accomplish that," he explained.

While "sustainable logging" might seem like an oxymoron, the practice is possible when done correctly. A forest can be kept healthy—and turn a profit—if the tree population is kept constant and only the excess growth is felled for timber each year. But according to Rick Samson, commissioner of Coös County, New Hampshire, where Wanger manages a Yale forest, the company seems to be ignoring these principles.

"I think what they decided is the best way they can maximize their investment is to liquidate the lumber and then try to find easements to take their place," Samson told *The Politic*. "My fear is that once they liquidate the lumber, it will be 50 or 75 years before there is any marketable lumber grown there again to sell."

Yale has no such fear. In a July 2017 Statement, the University said that Wagner Forest Management "practices sustainable forest management on the Bayroot LLC lands in

conformance with certification standards promulgated by the Sustainable Forestry Initiative (SFI) and the Forest Stewardship Council (FSC), as confirmed by independent auditors."

Clear-cutting the forest also has implications for the local economy.

"The only people that would be interested in buying that land and could afford to sit on it for 50 to 75 years would be the federal government, but the federal government would use our tax dollars to buy that land... and it's taken out of the tax base," Samson said. "So it appears to me that Yale's concern is their bottom financial line and their endowment, not the benefit of the county and the local communities."

While Wagner Forest Management has clear-cut certain tracts of Yale's property, it has left other stretches of forest intact. According to Samson, Wagner practices sustainable forest management and selective cutting in those parts of the property, in order to maintain its image.

"Those are the portions that they show reporters and the organizations to say they're sustainably managing the land," Samson said. "However, they do not go on the property where they clear-cut and there's nothing left."

According to the Sustainable Forestry Initiative website, forestland owners meet an array of environmental standards in order to receive certification from the Sustainable Forestry Initiative. The Forest Stewardship Council (FSC) similarly requires an independent auditor to verify that forest managers meet criteria in several key areas: compliance with laws and FSC principles, indigenous people's rights, community relations and workers' rights, environmental impact, and maintenance of high conservation value forests.

But Montgomery and Samson are skeptical of how much these certifications and sustainability standards really protect the forests.

"The FSC program is one that really looks at their management plans and determines whether their management plans are being adhered to. That's not to say they're looking at sustainable forest management," Montgomery said.

"FSC doesn't get into whether it's a good idea or not, they just say, okay, did you meet the terms of your management plan? And that could mean they could be clearcutting everything in sight, but it's not FSC's job to evaluate whether or not they're practicing good forestry."

Samson also believes there is a conflict of interest between logging companies and certification firms.

"Those two organizations are paid by Wagner to come in and do a report," he said. "They are not gonna come in and give them a bad report...because of course, if they do, they are not gonna get hired back."

Sophie Freeman '18, former president of the Yale Student Environmental Coalition, believes other forms of oversight are needed.

In an email to *The Politic*, Freeman wrote that "Wagner Forest Management should, at the very least, comply with forest sustainability standards as recommended by the Yale School of Forestry. Yale students, both undergraduate and graduate, have expressed their strong opposition to the lease and believe that Yale is acting in direct opposition to its professed values."

Criticism of Yale's forest management is not limited to its logging practices. On July 1, 2017, Bayroot LLC, the Yale-owned company that controls Yale's forests, approved a plan to build a

who's in charge

Wagner Forest Mgt Ltd. — handles logging; approved hydropower line; must comply with standards

Bayroot LLC — controls Yale's forests; contracts with Wagner Forest Management Ltd.

Yale Investments Office — manages the $25.4 billion Yale Endowment; controls Bayroot LLC



YALE'S FOREST LAND AT MILLSFIELD POND, NH, IN 2003 (below) AND 2015 (above). PHOTOS COURTESY OF **RICHARD SAMSON**

hydropower transmission line across a 24-mile strip of Yale-owned forest. The line would carry hydropower generated by plants owned by Hydro-Québec, a Canadian energy company, from Quebec to New England.

In an April 2017 article for the *Yale Daily News*, Freeman criticized the proposed plan for its potentially harmful environmental impact.

"One of the core tenets of the Yale Sustainability Plan 2025 is to 'plan and preserve resilient and sustainable infrastructure and landscapes,'" she wrote, "Yet can Yale really claim to be committed to sustainability if it controls a company which directly subverts this principle?'"

Samson opposed the program, too, and sent Yale a letter attempting to persuade Yale to terminate the deal.

"This university is on the verge of undermining the widespread and heroic conservation efforts in our county by leasing a 24-mile strip of land that is necessary for the development of Northern Pass," Samson wrote.

The University issued a statement in response to the growing opposition.

"Institutional investors such as Yale typically invest with managers through partnership arrangements that limit the investor's ability to control decisions from both a legal and best practices perspective," the statement read. "Wagner Forest Management did not have the ability to terminate the option to renew under the terms of the lease."

Samson said that he remains unconvinced. "If Yale owns the land, and they hire someone to manage it, and they are not managing it the way it should be, there is no doubt in my mind that Yale could either have them manage it properly or get someone else to manage it."

Montgomery said he believes Yale has the power to terminate the deal.

"These people are some of the greatest business minds in the world running this endowment," said Montgomery. "Do you think they'd put themselves in a situation where they didn't have an out if they needed it?"

Currently, the Northern Pass hydropower line project is undergoing a New Hampshire Site Evaluation Committee hearing that has dragged on as testimony continues to trickle in from all sides of the debate.

The potential environmental risks of the pipeline, if

"So it appears to me that Yale's concern is their bottom financial line and their endowment—not the benefit of the local communities."

approved by the committee, are severe. The pipeline would cut through the Great Northern Woods and the White Mountains, areas that contain some of the largest tracts of forestland in New England. According to the Appalachian Mountain Club, 90 to 140 national and state scenic viewpoints would be impacted by the route.

The Hydro-Québec project could contaminate many of the natural resources that the Pessamit Innu First Nation relies on, such as the population of salmon in the nearby Betsiamites River.

In the face of these threats, local communities are fighting back. Of the 32 towns in the project's area of impact, 31 voted to oppose the project, and the people of the Pessamit Innu First Nation have testified at the Site Evaluation Committee hearing in an effort to preserve their rights to resources. Coös County farmers refused huge offers for their land, choosing instead to forgo the money and obstruct the development of the project.

Yale, Samson believes, could fight back, too. By using the university's influence to stop the progress of the Northern Pass project, Yale would correct its previous failure to commit to sustainability and responsible investing.

The window to act, he said, has not yet closed: "I do believe that they could do the right thing."

on-line pre-view

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Breaking the Silence: Undocumented Students Tell Their Stories

BY **CARLOS RODRIGUEZ CORTEZ**

DACA extends to more than 800,000 people across America, some of whom are students at Yale. Carlos Rodriguez Cortez '21 explores the stories of Yalies who are impacted by Trump's DACA repeal. He also tells his own.

Activism and Slacktivism: Pantsuit Nation Ten Months After Trump

BY **HELEN ZHAO**

During the 2016 presidential election, Pantsuit Nation emerged as a Facebook group and forum for Hillary Clinton supporters, feminists, and activists. Ten months later, is the Pantsuit movement still alive? Helen Zhao '21 traces the group's origins, successes, and shortcomings.

All Eyes on Texas: Hurricane Harvey Batters the Lone Star State

BY **CHLOE HELLER**

Hurricane Harvey devastated Houston and southern Texas. Trillions of gallons of water flooded streets and buildings, leaving many residents without homes. Less than a month after Harvey made landfall, U.S. territories were hit twice more by the powerful Hurricanes Irma and Maria. Chloe Heller '21 examines how climate change has intensified natural disasters.

Precious Trash: Connecticut and Yale Avoid the Landfill in Sustainability Push

BY **PAIGE LAWRENCE**

New Haven's trash rarely ends up in a landfill, thanks to Connecticut's policies and Yale's commitment to sustainability. Paige Lawrence '21 follows the trash to find out.

Dashed Dreams: DACA Recipients Left in Limbo

BY **JACK KELLY**

For many recipients, DACA is a double-edged sword: In order to receive its benefits, students must take a gamble and reveal their undocumented status to the federal government. Today, DACA's repeal remains in flux—and so do the status and well-being of thousands of undocumented college students in the United States. Jack Kelly '21 investigates.

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